THE BINGHAM FAMILY REUNION 2026

From Many Lands

Twelve Stories for Young Readers

A companion to The Covenant Path From Many Lands

Read aloud to the children. Read the notes yourself.

A Note for the Grown Ups

Every story in this book is true. The twelve families in these pages are the families who first joined The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter day Saints in the Bingham line. Each story was written to be read aloud to a child between about three and nine years old. The words are simple on purpose. The events are not simplified away.

How each story is built. A story opens with its own title page, then runs a picture to a page with a line or two of words underneath. At the end of every story there are notes for the grown up who is reading. Those notes set out what the record actually says, what was made simpler for a young listener, and what was left out. They also list the FamilySearch identifiers so you can go look for yourself.

Where the full account lives. This book is a companion to The Covenant Path From Many Lands, the full reunion volume. Anything here that a child asks about is treated at length there, with the sources set out in full.

A word about the pictures. The illustrations are drawn to help a young child picture a place and a moment. They are not photographs and they are not portraits of the people named. No likeness of any of these ancestors survives.

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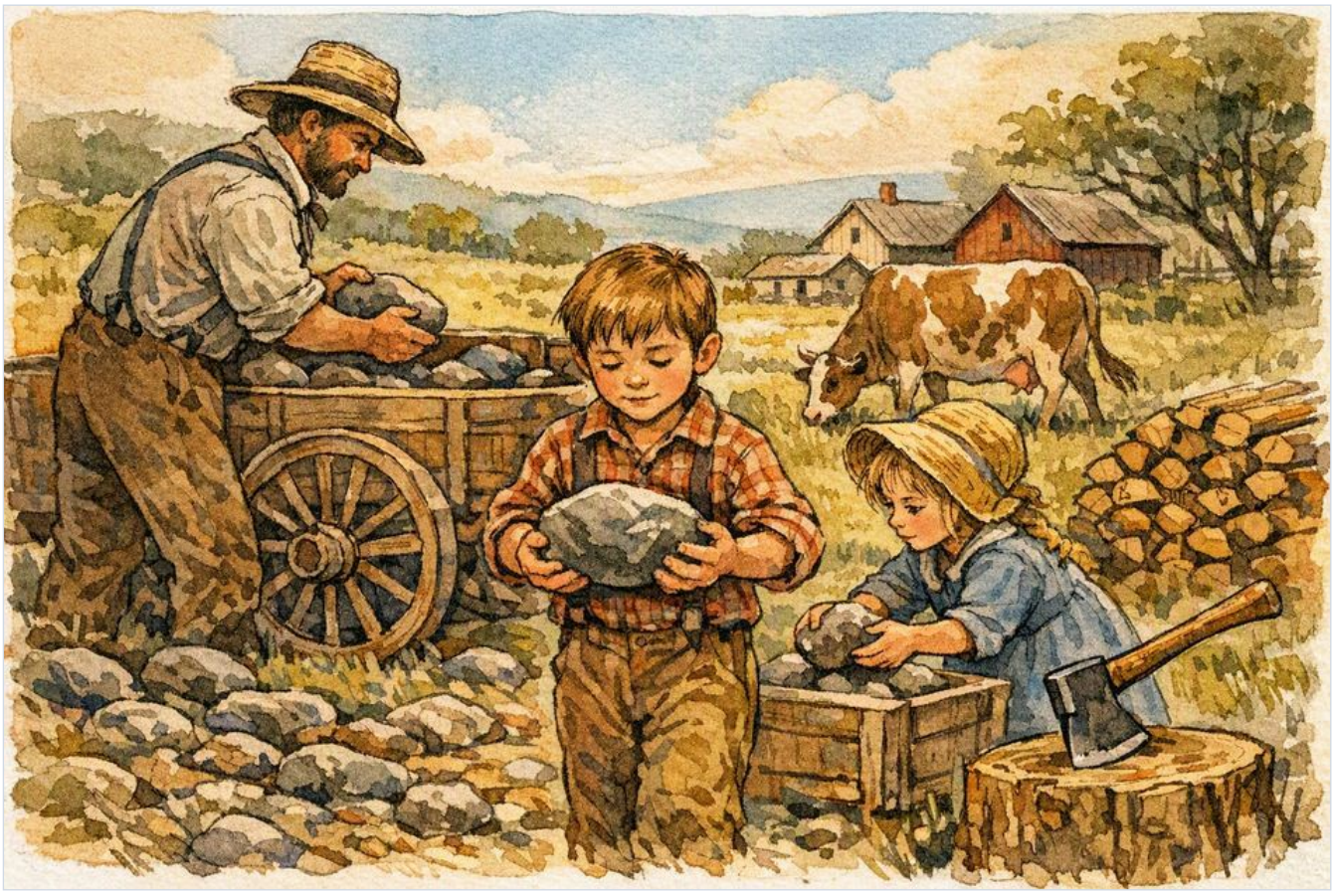
STORY ONE OF TWELVE

Twelve Men at the Door

Erastus Bingham and Lucinda Gates

Erastus and Lucinda lived on a hill in Vermont. It was hard to grow plants there because the dirt was full of rocks. But they worked hard and built a house.



Every spring they pulled rocks out of the field. Every fall they cut wood for winter. Their children carried water and milked the cows. It was hard work, but they were a happy family.

One day a man came up the road with a book. He said a prophet was alive again and had translated it with God’s help. Erastus read the book and believed it.

In November the water was very cold. But because they believed, Erastus and Lucinda were baptized that day. Three of their children were baptized too.

One autumn night twelve men knocked on the door. They were Apostles, and one was Brigham Young. They talked late and slept in the house. That was a special experience for the Binghams.

Erastus and Lucinda decided to move to where other baptized people were living. They bought a small brown book. Everyone they loved wrote goodbye to them in the book. Then they sold the farm and went west.

They stopped in Ohio and saw the new temple, but some people were unhappy. So they then went on to Missouri. There they built another house.

People there also became unhappy. Men came and told the Saints to leave. Erastus stayed all winter to help poor families go first. Then he took his own family away to Illinois.

In Illinois they built another house. But soon they had to leave that one too. They crossed the frozen river in February.

Native families nearby offered them a winter camp. Some people were afraid to go even though Brigham Young said they should. Erastus stood on a wagon wheel and said he would follow the prophet.

The next summer the wagons began to roll west. It was a hard trip. Every night Lucinda and her daughters sang by the fire. The singing helped the tired people go one more day.

Finally, they reached Utah. Brigham Young asked people to build forts. Erastus built a fort out of logs. Everyone called it Bingham's Fort. That name came all the way down to you.

About This Story

Twelve Men at the Door · Erastus Bingham and Lucinda Gates

This little book is drawn from the full account of Erastus Bingham and Lucinda Gates in The Covenant Path From Many Lands. Nothing here is invented. What follows tells a grown up reader which parts are documented, which parts were simplified for a young listener, and what was left out.

What the record says

In the book	In the record
A hill in Vermont	Erastus Bingham was born 12 March 1798 in Concord, Essex County, Vermont. Lucinda Gates was born 19 September 1797 in Acworth, Cheshire County, New Hampshire. They married 20 March 1820 in St. Johnsbury, Vermont, and farmed in Concord.
A man came up the road with a book	Elder John F. Boynton preached in Vermont in the spring of 1833 and gave Erastus the Book of Mormon. He was ordained an Apostle in February 1835.
In November the water was very cold	Erastus, Lucinda, and their children Mary, Erastus Jr., and Thomas were baptized 11 November 1833 at St. Johnsbury, Vermont, by Elder Evans. Their son Sanford was baptized one week later on 18 November.
Twelve men knocked on the door	In the fall of 1835 the newly called Quorum of the Twelve Apostles traveled through New England. All twelve stayed one night at the Bingham home and held a council meeting there. Brigham Young later told Erastus in Nauvoo that it was the only Apostolic council meeting ever held at a private member's home in Vermont.
A small brown book	The Sally Bingham Album, a brown leather notebook Erastus bought before leaving Vermont, in which family and friends wrote parting thoughts. It is digitized in the Erastus Bingham Sr. Memories Collection on FamilySearch.
Ohio and the new temple	The family sold the Concord farm in September 1836 and traveled to Kirtland, Ohio, where the temple had been dedicated that spring. They reached Shoal Creek near Far West, Missouri, on 4 November 1836.
Men came and told the Saints to leave	Governor Boggs issued the Extermination Order in the fall of 1838. Erastus was appointed to the Committee of Removal, which stayed behind in Missouri through the winter to sell the property of families who had to flee. He left Far West in late March 1839.

In the book	In the record
The frozen river in February	The family settled in Hancock County, Illinois, and bought land near Nauvoo in 1845. They crossed the frozen Mississippi in early 1846. Erastus was appointed a Captain of one hundred for the crossing of Iowa.
A wagon wheel and a winter camp	Food was scarce at Council Bluffs. Native Americans friendly to the Saints invited them to share a winter camping ground called Swift Water. Many hesitated. Erastus stood up on a wagon wheel, announced that his family would accept, and persuaded the rest of the camp to stay.
Singing by the fire	The family crossed with the Daniel Spencer and Ira Eldredge Company, about 177 people and 76 wagons, departing the Elkhorn River 17 June 1847 and reaching the Salt Lake Valley between 19 and 22 September 1847. Journals record that Lucinda and her daughters led the evening singing.
A fort of logs	Erastus was called as Bishop of the North Ward in Ogden. In August 1851 a fort was built on his family farmland and given the name Bingham's Fort, in the words of the community record, in honor of the Bishop Erastus Bingham of the North Ward.

What was simplified

Only three people are named in this book. That is on purpose, because young children lose track of names quickly. The missionary who brought the Book of Mormon and the elder who performed the baptisms are both real and both named above, but neither is named on a story page.

The family built homes in Vermont, Ohio, Missouri, Illinois near Carthage, and again near Nauvoo. The two Illinois homes are told as one house on page nine.

The wagon company is not named on a story page. It is named in the table above.

What was left out

Three members of the family enlisted in the Mormon Battalion on 16 July 1846. They were the sons Erastus Jr. and Thomas, and the son in law Elijah Norman Freeman, who was the husband of the eldest daughter Mary. Freeman fell ill on the march and died on 28 November 1846. He was 24 years old. Erastus Jr. and Thomas survived and reached the Salt Lake Valley on 29 July 1847. This is a reunion game fact, and it belongs in a family history, but it is a death and a war and it is not a picture book page.

One point remains unsettled. The FamilySearch profile for Erastus Bingham Sr. carries a note stating that he did not serve in the Battalion himself, and the family history places him at Council Bluffs during those months. The Mormon Battalion historic site in San Diego lists a name that some researchers read as his. The full

account flags this conflict rather than resolving it, and so does this book. Lucinda died on 3 January 1874 and Erastus on 2 May 1882. Both are buried at the Ogden City Cemetery. Their deaths are recorded in the full account and are deliberately not part of this book, which ends at the gate of the fort.

Reunion game facts in this book

Game fact	Where it is
Born in Vermont in 1798 and farmed the thin New England soil	Pages one and two
Baptized in November 1833 along with three of the children	Page four
All twelve Apostles stayed the night and held a council meeting at the house	Page five
Expelled from Missouri and then from Illinois	Pages eight and nine
Wintered near Council Bluffs with Native friends of the Saints	Page ten
Lucinda and her daughters sang around the campfire every evening	Page eleven
A pioneer fort in Ogden was named after him	Page twelve

Game fact	Where it is
Two sons and a son in law enlisted in the Mormon Battalion, and Erastus Sr. did not	This back matter, under what was left out

Where this book touches the others

The gate on page twelve is the same gate the Aldous family walked through. Robert and Mary Ann Aldous reached Bingham's Fort in 1854, three years after it was built, and Robert put his carpentry to work on its walls and cabins. In December 1862 their daughter Angelina Theresa Aldous married Brigham Heber Bingham, a son of Erastus, and the two families became one. Their story is Freezing Waters, a Broken Ship, and Bingham's Fort.

FamilySearch identifiers

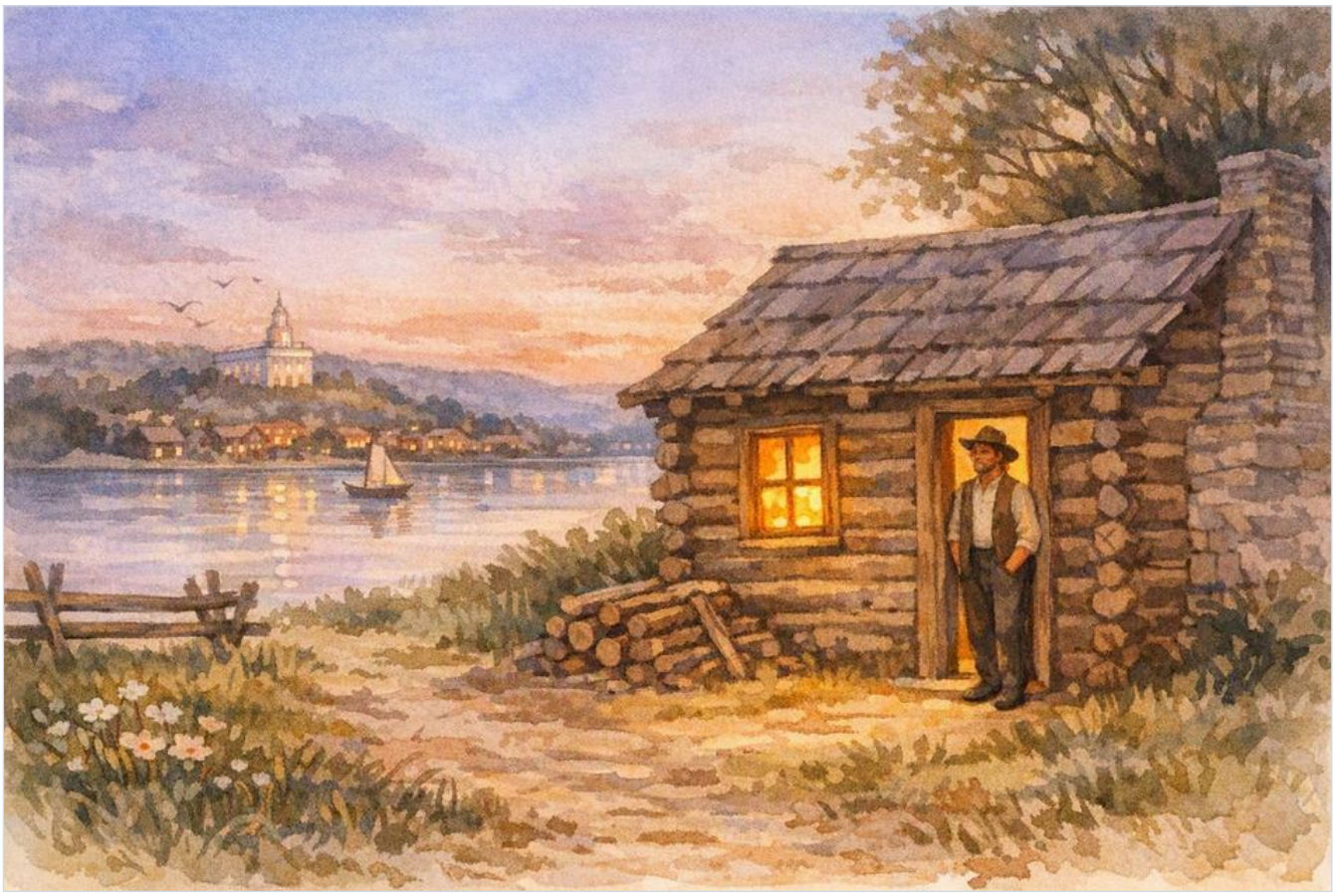
Person	FamilySearch ID
Erastus Bingham Sr. (1798 to 1882)	KWJ4-KJ3
Lucinda Gates (1797 to 1874)	KWJ4-KJ9

Prepared for the Bingham Family Reunion, 2026. Companion to The Covenant Path From Many Lands, story one of twelve.

STORY TWO OF TWELVE

The Prophet Under the Bed

Lewis Dunbar Wilson and Nancy Ann Waggoner



Long ago, beside a wide river, there was a busy little city. Its name was Nauvoo. Lewis lived there with his family. He made strong wooden barrels.

Lewis and Nancy Ann had a baby boy in Nauvoo. They named him Lewis too. So everyone called him little Lewis. Their home was close to friends who believed as they did.

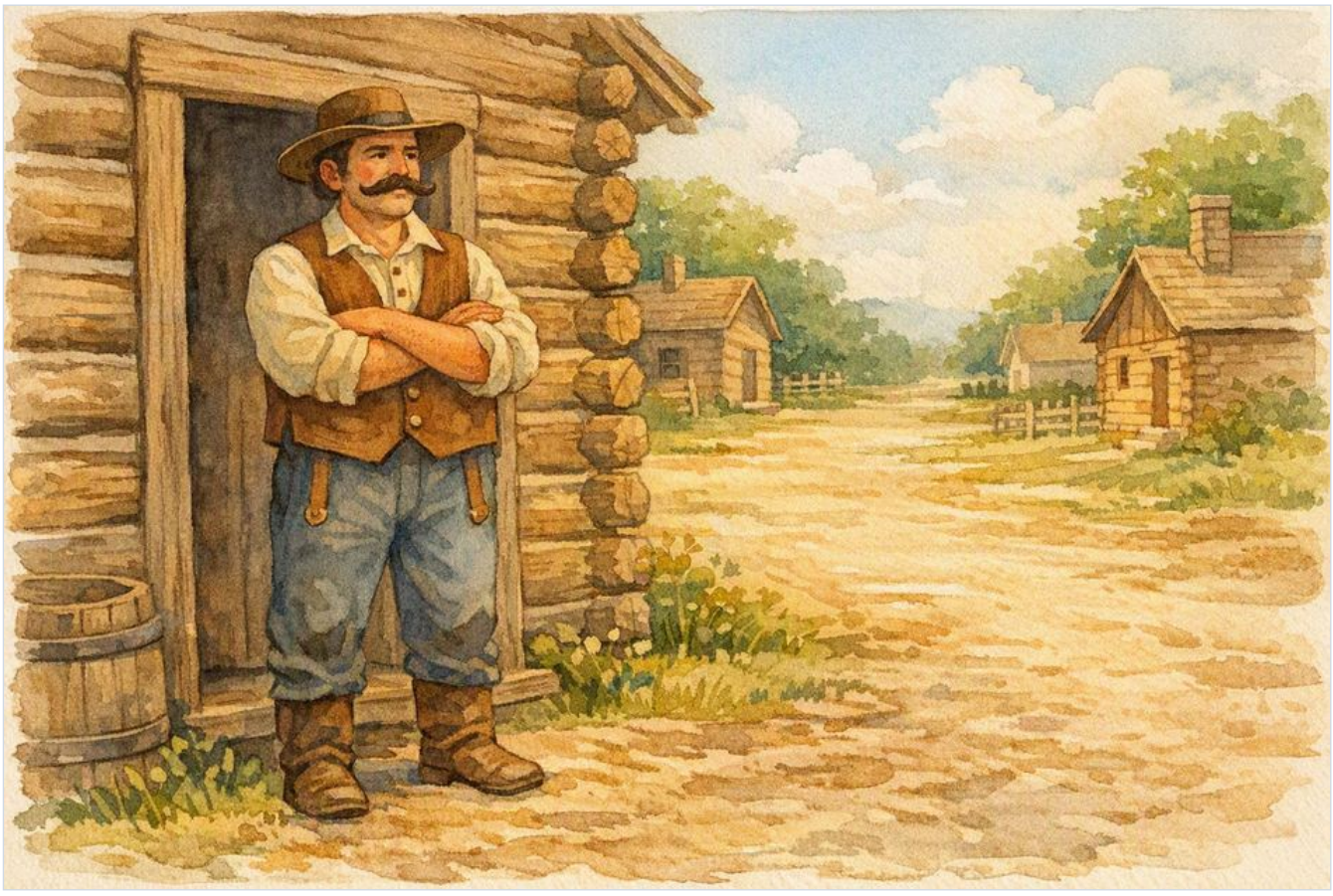
The leader of the Church was a prophet named Joseph Smith. Sometimes he came to visit the Wilson home. He held little Lewis on his knee and told him stories. Little Lewis remembered that all his life.

But not everyone was kind to the Saints. One summer day, men took Joseph far from home. They would not let him go. Lewis climbed on his horse and rode to help.

Lewis and his friends found Joseph and brought him home. People hurried into the street to welcome him. Joseph remembered the friends who came for him.

After that, Joseph asked Lewis to help watch over him. Lewis's job was to help keep him safe. Joseph gave Lewis a sword to thank him. The family kept it for years and years.

One day, angry men came looking for Joseph again. Joseph hurried to the Wilson house. He knocked at the door. Nancy Ann opened it quickly and brought him inside.



Nancy Ann knew just what to do. She helped Joseph hide under her bed. Lewis stood outside the door. He stayed there until the men went away.

Inside the quiet house, little Lewis watched and listened. He was still a small boy. But he remembered that brave day for the rest of his life. His mother and father had helped keep Joseph safe.

Two years later, Joseph died. The Saints were very sad. Soon they had to leave Nauvoo and go west. They packed their wagons and crossed the frozen river.

Little Lewis kept growing as the family traveled. When he was twelve, he walked to Utah beside the wagons. He helped guide the oxen over the mountains. The sword went with the family too.

Years passed. Little Lewis grew old, but he kept the sword. He kept the story too, and told it to his children. They told it to their children, until it came all the way to you.

About This Story

The Prophet Under the Bed · Lewis Dunbar Wilson and Nancy Ann Waggoner

This little book is drawn from the full account of Lewis Dunbar Wilson and Nancy Ann Waggoner in The Covenant Path From Many Lands. Nothing here is invented. What follows tells a grown up reader which parts are documented, which parts were simplified for a young listener, and what was left out.

This is an Incident Story. It covers about four years in Nauvoo and does not try to tell the whole life. The full account begins in Vermont in 1805 and ends in Ogden in 1856.

What the record says

In the book	In the record
A man named Lewis who made barrels	Lewis Dunbar Wilson was born 2 June 1805 in Milton, Chittenden County, Vermont. He worked as a cooper, which is a barrel maker, and as a farmer. He married Nancy Ann Waggoner on 11 June 1830 in Richland County, Ohio, and they were baptized on 23 May 1836. The family reached Nauvoo in late November 1839.
Their baby boy in Nauvoo	Lewis Dunbar Wilson Jr. was born 21 September 1840 in Nauvoo. He is the ancestor through whom this line descends. Calling him little Lewis is this book's way of keeping two men with the same name apart for a young listener.
The prophet held him on his knee	Lewis Jr. recalled sitting on the knee of the Prophet Joseph Smith as a small boy while Joseph told stories. Recorded in the History of Lewis Dunbar Wilson Jr., compiled by Ethel Wilson Harrison.
Men took the prophet far from home	In July 1843 Joseph Smith was arrested at Dixon, Illinois, by Missouri agents seeking to extradite him. Lewis was among the men who rode out to intercept the officers and bring the Prophet back to Nauvoo. The full account notes this was an overland ride on horseback and not a steamboat expedition.
The prophet gave Lewis a sword	Because of his part in the Dixon rescue, Lewis was assigned as one of Joseph Smith's personal bodyguards. The Prophet gave him a sword in recognition of his service. Lewis Jr. kept that sword for the rest of his life.
Hiding under the bed	Lewis Jr. described the day a mob chased Joseph Smith into his father's home. His mother hid the Prophet under the bed while his father went outside to hold the crowd back. Same source as above.

In the book	In the record
Leaving Nauvoo	Joseph and Hyrum Smith were killed at Carthage in June 1844. Lewis and Nancy Ann received their endowments in the Nauvoo Temple in December 1845 and were sealed there on 19 January 1846, in Lewis's own diary's wording, in the house of the Lord. They left with the first company and crossed the frozen Mississippi, reaching Garden Grove, Iowa, on 7 February 1846.
Walking to Utah at twelve	The family crossed with the Daniel A. Miller and John W. Cooley Company, departing 8 June 1853 and reaching the Salt Lake Valley on 9 September 1853. Lewis Jr., born September 1840, was twelve years old and walked beside the wagons handling the livestock over the mountain passes.

What was simplified

Four people are named in this book. They are Lewis, Nancy Ann, little Lewis, and Joseph Smith. Everyone else is his friends or the men who came.

Page eight leaves out one detail. The record says Lewis went outside with a gun to keep the mob away. This book has him stand in his own doorway and not move, because a weapon on a picture book page is not something a three year old needs to see. The fact is here instead.

The book opens in Nauvoo and says nothing about Vermont, Ohio, Kirtland, or the expulsion from Missouri. All of that comes before page one and is told in the full account.

Page ten says the prophet was killed and moves on in the next sentence. That is deliberate.

What was left out

Nancy Ann Waggoner died on 19 July 1851 in Iowa, ten hours after giving birth to her last son, Samuel. She was forty years old. She had borne ten children and had survived Missouri, Nauvoo, and five years of poverty in Iowa, and she never saw Utah. She is buried in Iowa soil and the exact place was not recorded. Her death is a reunion game fact and it belongs in a family history, but it is not a picture book page.

Lewis Dunbar Wilson died on 11 March 1856 in Ogden, Weber County, Utah, at the age of fifty. He is buried in the Ogden City Cemetery.

In October 1839 Lewis was sustained as one of the first members of the Nauvoo High Council, a calling named in Doctrine and Covenants section 124, verse 132. He was ordained to it by the Patriarch Hyrum Smith. This is a reunion game fact and it is left off the story pages because it needs more explaining than a page can hold.

The full account includes a temple sealing between Lewis and a young woman named Martha Minerva Reynolds in February 1846, which the evidence indicates was an eternity only sealing rather than a marriage. It is discussed there and is not

part of this book.

Reunion game facts in this book

Game fact	Where it is
The Prophet Joseph Smith gave Lewis a sword for his service as a bodyguard	Pages six and twelve
His son Lewis Jr. kept that sword his whole life	Pages eleven and twelve
Nancy Ann hid a prophet under her bed to protect him from a mob	Pages seven and eight
Lewis Jr. crossed the plains at twelve, walking beside the wagons and handling the oxen	Page eleven
Lewis was a member of the original Nauvoo High Council named in Doctrine and Covenants 124	This back matter, under what was left out
Nancy Ann bore ten children and died in Iowa without ever seeing Utah	This back matter, under what was left out

Game fact	Where it is
The family followed the Saints from Vermont to Ohio, Missouri, Nauvoo, and finally Utah	This back matter, under what was simplified

Where this book touches the others

The boy walking beside the wagon on page eleven grew up in Ogden. On the last day of 1862 he married Catherine Wiggins, who had crossed the plains in 1852 with her own family. Her parents are Ebenezer Fairchild Wiggins and Eleanor Moore, and their story is the next book in this set. Lewis and Catherine's daughter, Catharine Rozella Wilson, later married Brigham Albert Bingham, which ties this family to Erastus Bingham and Lucinda Gates in Twelve Men at the Door.

FamilySearch identifiers

Person	FamilySearch ID
Lewis Dunbar Wilson Sr. (1805 to 1856)	KWV9-C9X
Nancy Ann Waggoner (1810 to 1851)	KWV9-C96
Lewis Dunbar Wilson Jr. (born 1840)	KWDM-FSM

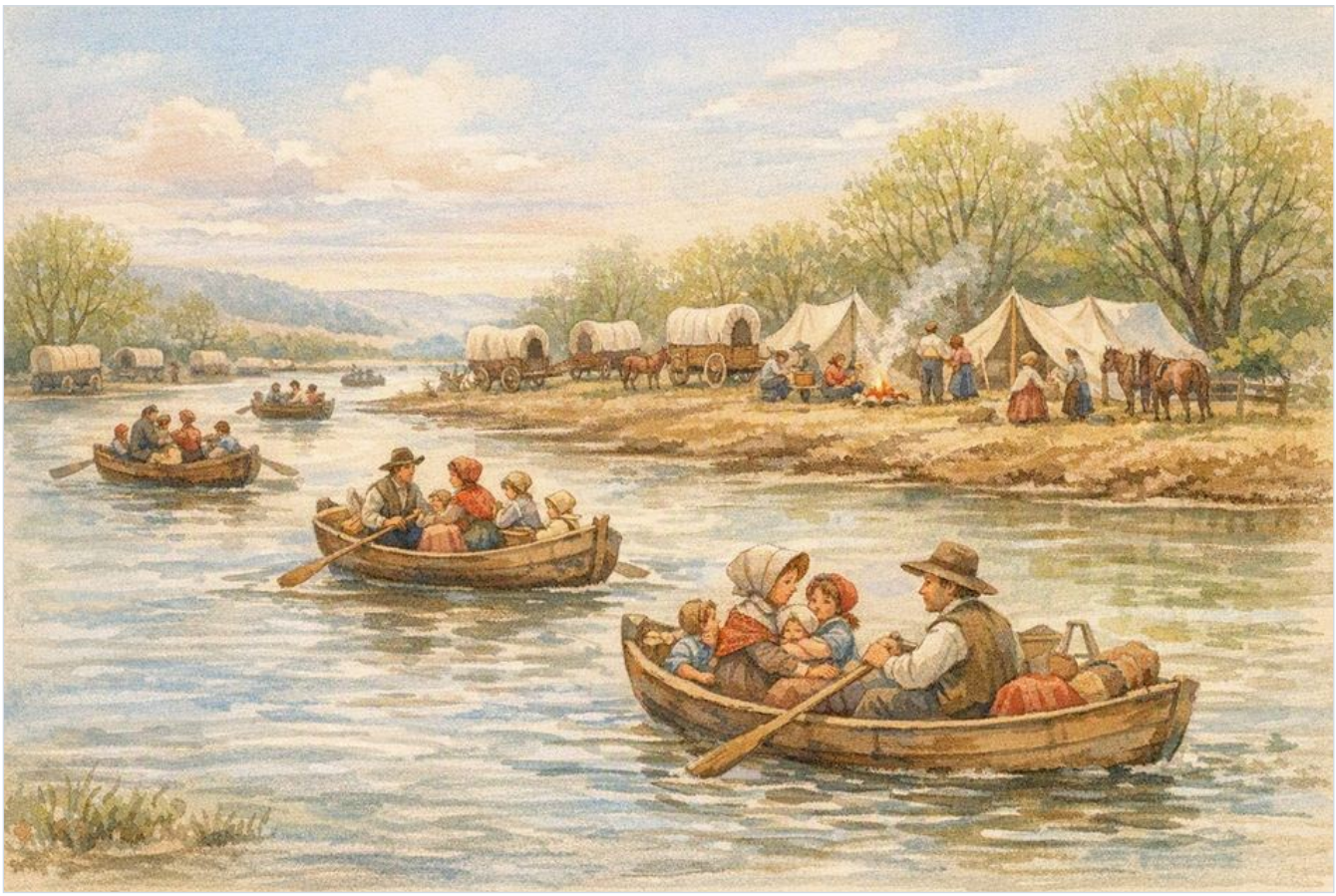
Prepared for the Bingham Family Reunion, 2026. Companion to The Covenant Path From Many Lands, story two of twelve.

STORY THREE OF TWELVE

The Wagon in the Yard

Ebenezer Wiggins and Eleanor Moore

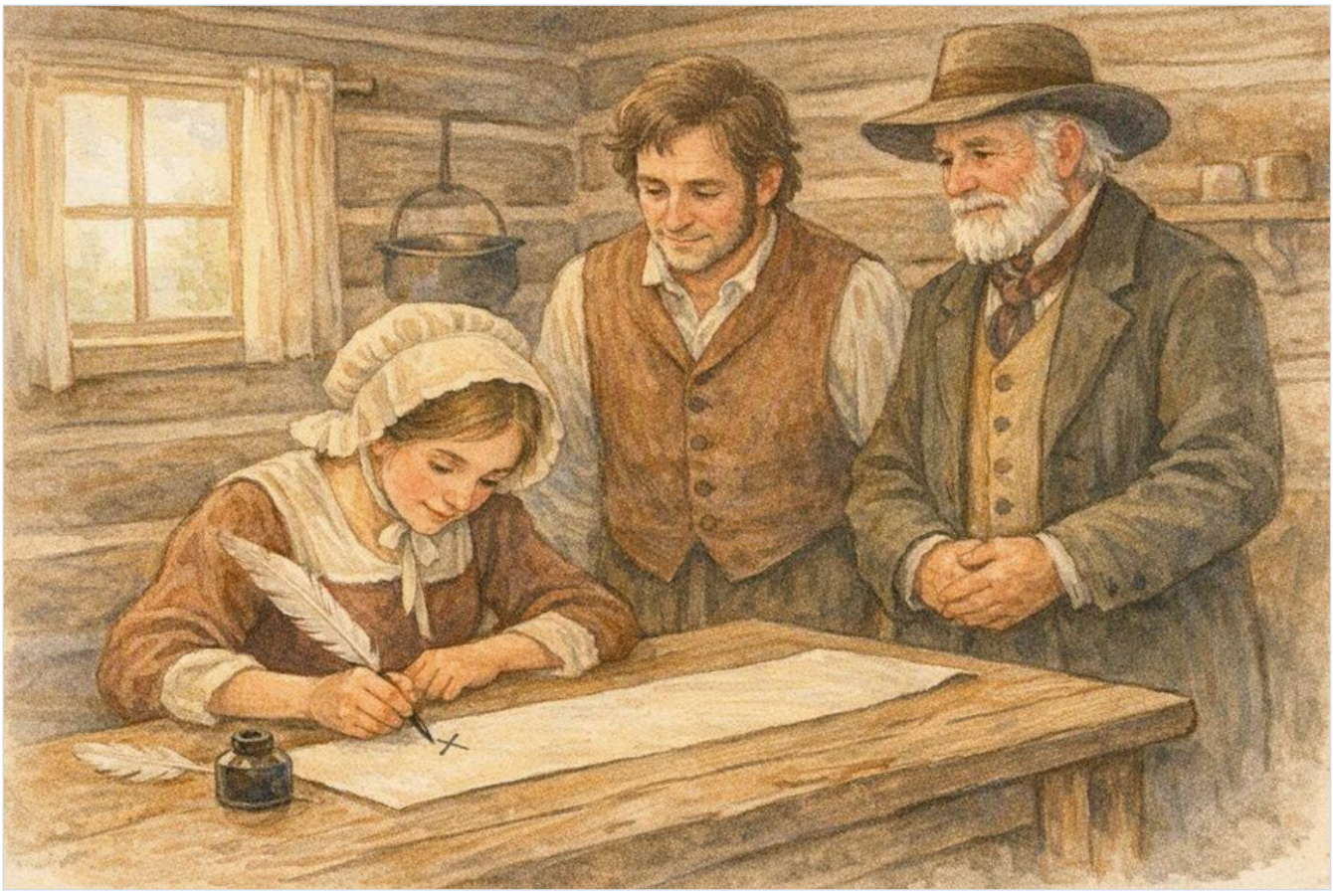
Long ago, beside a wide shining river in Illinois, Ebenezer and Eleanor Wiggins lived on a farm with their children. They planted corn, cut timber, and worked from morning until the sun went down.



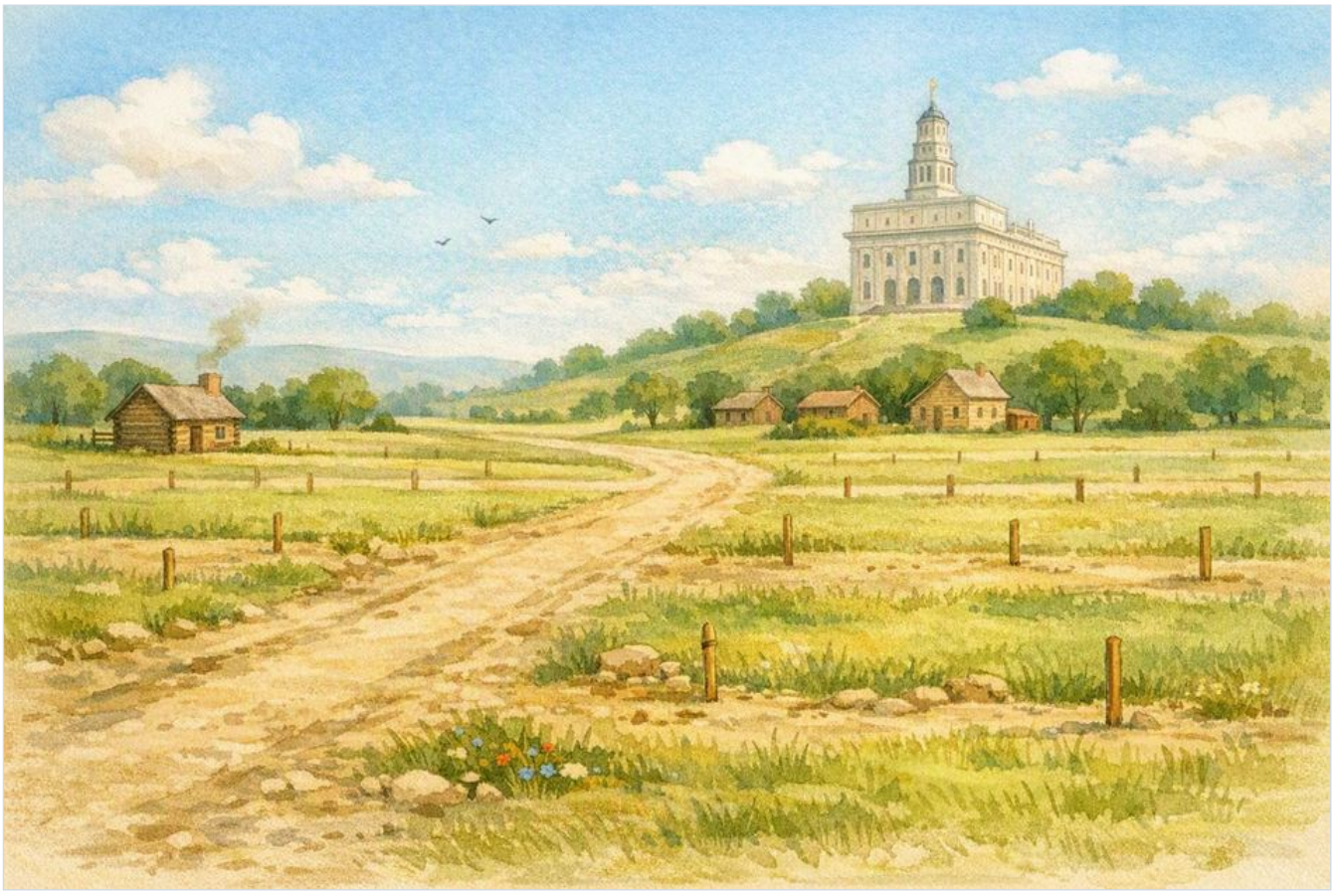
One spring, many tired families came across the river. They had lost their homes far away, and they were looking for a safe place to begin again. They stopped nearby and began to build a city called Nauvoo.

The new neighbors worked and sang. They talked about Jesus and the gospel. Ebenezer and Eleanor listened for a long time. One cold January, they were baptized too.

The prophet wanted to buy more land. So his wife, Emma, came out to see about buying the farm. Ebenezer thought it over. Then he said yes.



Emma paid two thousand seven hundred dollars. Ebenezer wrote his name, but Eleanor had never learned to write her name, so she made her mark instead. Just one small X.



But Emma did not pay it all with money. Some of the payment was goods, and some was land in the new city. Ebenezer took the city lots and waited.

About a year later, Ebenezer traded one city lot back to the Church. He did not take only money. He took silver, and he took a wagon with two strong horses.

The wagon stood in the yard beside the house. There was no farm anymore. But a wagon can go somewhere. A farm has to stay where it is.

Then the Saints, the people who had built Nauvoo, were told to leave Illinois. In February the river froze hard. Ebenezer and Eleanor packed the wagon and gathered all seven children. Baby Catherine was not yet one.

On the other side, they stopped in Iowa and waited. They waited six long years, saving food and animals for the road. Other families rolled west while Ebenezer, Eleanor, and the children stayed behind.

At last their turn came. They joined the very last wagon train of the year, sixty-three wagons in a long dusty line. In September they came down through the canyons and saw the valley.

Catherine grew up in that valley. When she was seventeen, she married a young man named Lewis. He had walked to Utah beside his own wagon. And because they had a family, this old wagon story has come all the way to you.

About This Story

The Wagon in the Yard · Ebenezer Wiggins and Eleanor Moore

This little book is drawn from the full account of Ebenezer Fairchild Wiggins and Eleanor Moore in The Covenant Path From Many Lands. Nothing here is invented. What follows tells a grown up reader which parts are documented, which parts were simplified for a young listener, and what was left out.

This is an Incident Story built around one sale and one wagon. It runs from 1839 to 1852 and does not try to tell the whole life.

What the record says

In the book	In the record
A farm on the edge of a great river	Ebenezer Fairchild Wiggins was born 4 February 1806 in Millersburg, Bourbon County, Kentucky. He married Eleanor Moore on 25 October 1832 in Hancock County, Illinois. Their farm was in Appanoose Township, Section 30, a few miles north of the bend in the river that became Nauvoo. He received 116 acres from Samuel Wiggins and added a federal land patent in October 1840.
Thousands of tired people came across the river	In the spring of 1839 the Saints, expelled from Missouri by the Extermination Order, crossed into Hancock County and settled at a malarial bend called Commerce, which they renamed Nauvoo. The Wiggins family were already living a few miles away and watched the city rise.
One cold January they were baptized	Ebenezer and Eleanor were baptized in January 1841, the same season the Nauvoo Temple foundations were laid. The FamilySearch ordinance record carries 1 January 1841, but that is a standard placeholder for a year date and the exact day in January is not known.
Emma came out to the farm	On 14 and 15 May 1841 Ebenezer entered into an agreement and a deed with Emma Smith, wife of the Prophet Joseph Smith. Joseph was operating under bankruptcy protection and could not hold property in his own name, so Emma was the legal titleholder for the household. The agreement is preserved in the Joseph Smith Papers and the deed in the Hancock County Deed records.
Two thousand seven hundred dollars	The price was $2,700. Emma paid $1,100 down, being $100 in goods and $1,000 in Nauvoo town lots, with the remaining $1,600 due in three yearly payments of $533.33. The deed was witnessed by R. B. Thompson, Joseph Smith's secretary, and acknowledged before Ebenezer Robinson, Justice of the Peace.

In the book	In the record
Eleanor made her own mark	Eleanor could not write. She signed both the agreement and the recorded deed with a mark, an X, as was ordinary for many frontier women of her generation.
Silver and a wagon with two horses	On 30 August 1842 Ebenezer sold Lot 3, Block 125 of the Nauvoo Plat back to the Church trustee for $800. The receipt of 17 September 1842 records what he took in payment, including $31.00 in cash and bank notes, $119.00 in silver, and one wagon with a span of horses and harness valued at $225.00.
The frozen river in February	The family crossed the Mississippi into Iowa Territory in the early months of 1846 with all seven children. Rebecca had been born in March 1843 and Catherine in April 1845 at LaHarpe, Hancock County. Every one of the seven had been born in Illinois.
Six long years in Iowa	The 1850 Federal Census found the family in Pottawattamie County, Iowa, at the settlement of Kanesville, later Council Bluffs, with Ebenezer listed as a farmer and all seven children in the household.
The final wagon train of the whole year	They departed Kanesville on 8 July 1852 with the Henry W. Miller Company, roughly 229 people and 63 wagons, the twentieth and last company of the 1852 season. They came into the Salt Lake Valley on 10 September 1852 and settled at Ogden.
Catherine married a young man named Lewis	Catherine Wiggins married Lewis Dunbar Wilson Jr. on 31 December 1862 in Ogden. She was seventeen. He had crossed the plains at twelve in 1853, which is the boy on page eleven of The Prophet Under the Bed.

One thing this book is careful not to claim

The full account raises the possibility that the wagon Ebenezer took in trade in 1842 was the same wagon that carried the family out of Illinois in 1846 and on to Utah in 1852. That is a reasonable guess and it is not proven. This book never says it is the same wagon. Page nine says only that they packed their wagon, which is true whichever wagon it was. A reader who feels the connection is welcome to it, but the record does not go that far.

What was simplified

Five people are named in this book. They are Ebenezer, Eleanor, Emma, Catherine, and Lewis. Joseph Smith is on page four as the prophet rather than by name, only because naming him would have made six.

Page five says Ebenezer wrote his name and Eleanor made her mark. Both signed twice, once on the agreement of 14 May and again when the deed was recorded the next day.

The city lots and the yearly payments are told in plain terms. The actual arrangement was $100 in goods, $1,000 in town property, and three notes of $533.33 each.

What was left out

In July 1844, weeks after the deaths of Joseph and Hyrum Smith, Ebenezer went down into the font in the basement of the Nauvoo Temple and was baptized on behalf of his own father, Jonas Wiggins, who had died in Kentucky in 1832. It is recorded in the Nauvoo Baptismal Records of the Dead, Book D80.

Ebenezer received his temple endowment on 6 November 1852, within weeks of reaching the valley. He died in Ogden on 5 December 1858 at the age of fifty two, six years after the wagons came through the canyon. Eleanor was left with the younger children and lived thirteen more years. She died in Ogden in 1871 and is buried there. Catherine was thirteen when her father died.

Catherine remembered the Apostle Orson Hyde visiting their home and bringing her the first piece of fruit she ever tasted in Utah. She grew up to teach school in Ogden and was known as an expert speller.

Reunion game facts in this book

Game fact	Where it is
Sold the family farm to Emma Smith, the wife of the Prophet, for $2,700	Pages four, five, and six
Took part of the payment in Nauvoo town lots rather than money	Page six
Eleanor crossed the frozen Mississippi with seven children, the youngest under a year old	Page nine

Game fact	Where it is
Waited six years in Iowa before they could afford the crossing	Page ten
Came west with the last emigrant company of the 1852 season	Page eleven
Their daughter Catherine married Lewis Dunbar Wilson Jr.	Page twelve

Where this book touches the others

The young man on page twelve is the little boy from The Prophet Under the Bed. Catherine Wiggins and Lewis Dunbar Wilson Jr. married in Ogden on the last day of 1862, joining two families who had crossed the country by different roads eleven years apart. Their daughter Catharine Rozella Wilson married Brigham Albert Bingham, which carries the line into Twelve Men at the Door.

FamilySearch identifiers

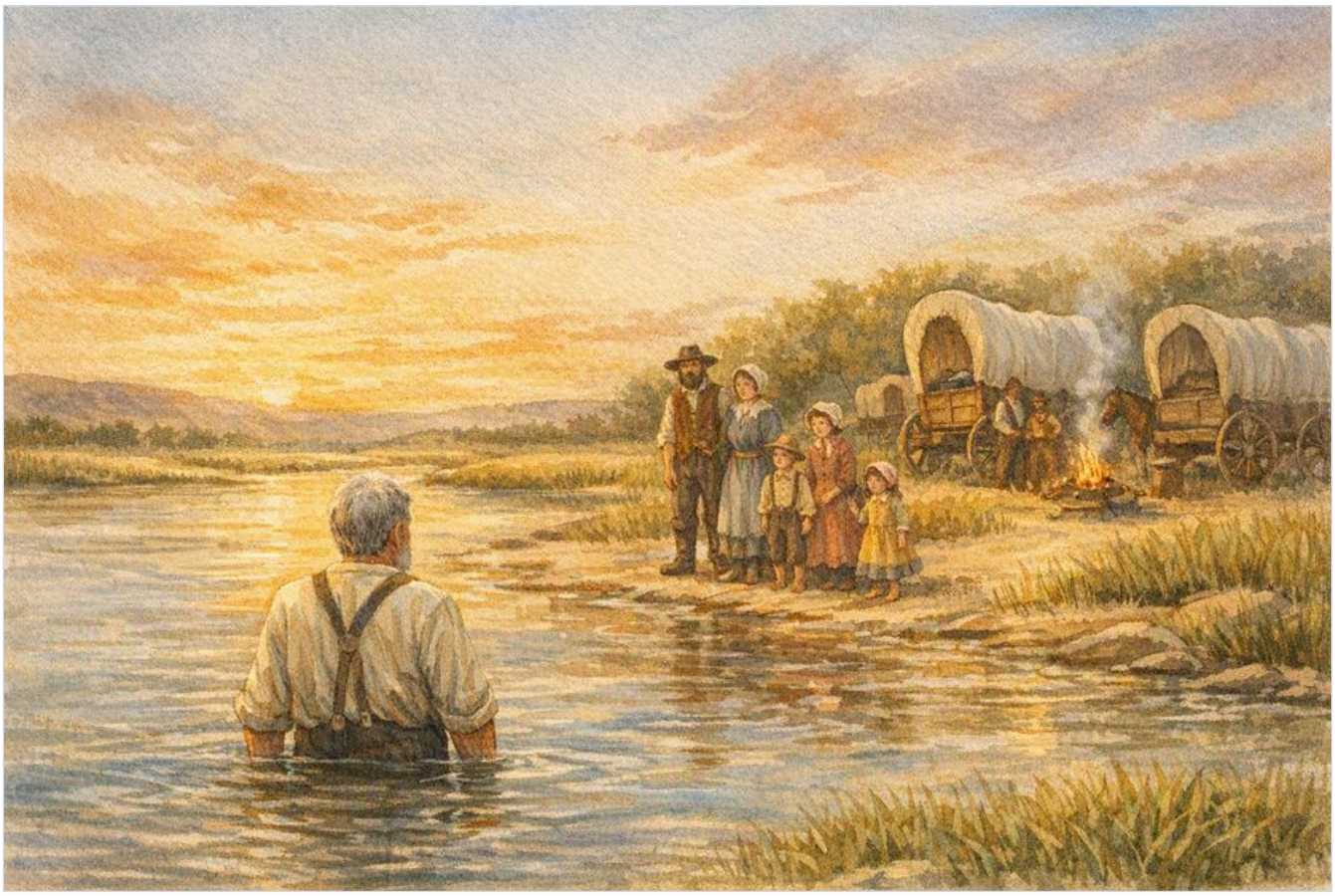
Person	FamilySearch ID
Ebenezer Fairchild Wiggins (1806 to 1858)	KWV3-MW9
Eleanor Moore (about 1810 to 1871)	KWV3-MWM
Catherine Wiggins (born 1845)	KWZJ-KSN

Prepared for the Bingham Family Reunion, 2026. Companion to The Covenant Path From Many Lands, story three of twelve.

STORY FOUR OF TWELVE

The Promise in the River

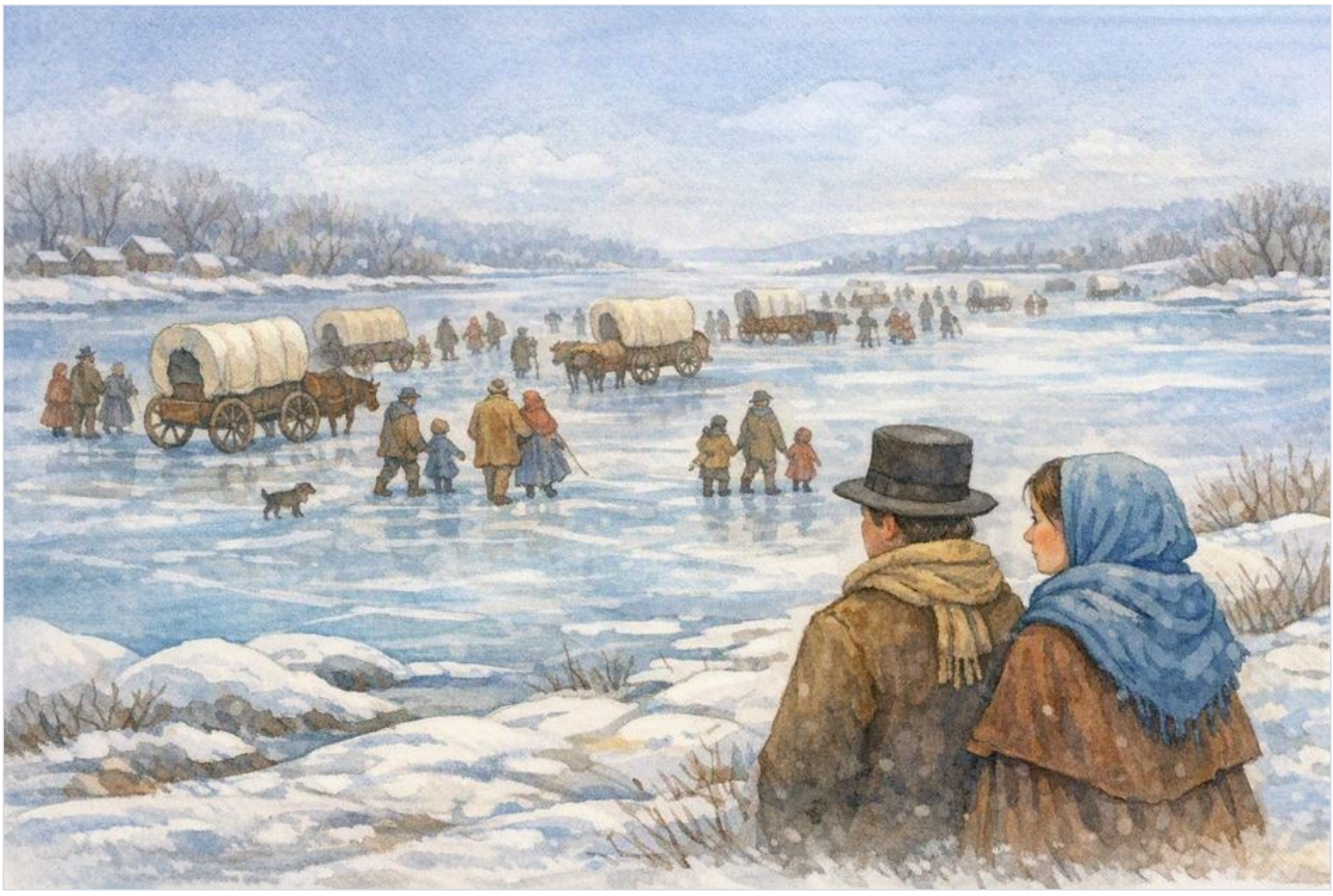
Edward Farley Jr. and Mary Ann Moore



Long ago, Edward and Mary Ann Farley had a farm on a bend of the Mississippi River. It was a quiet, swampy place. Hardly anyone else lived there at all.

One spring, thousands of tired people came across the river. They had been driven from their homes far away. They began to build a city right around the Farley farm.

They called the city Nauvoo. Day by day, the Farleys watched it grow. On the hill, a temple began to rise. For eight years, Edward and Mary Ann watched, but they did not join.



Then trouble came, and the people had to leave. One cold February the river froze hard. Edward and Mary Ann stood on the bank and watched them all walk across the ice.

The city went quiet. But Edward and Mary Ann could not forget what they had seen. One spring day, at last, they were baptized too.

Now Edward and Mary Ann wanted to go west with the others. They sold their land. They packed their wagons. They took seventeen wagons and three hundred cattle.

At the Missouri River they joined a great company of wagons. There were one hundred and thirty-six wagons in the line. Then they all started west together.

The road was long and hard. Many people got sick along the way. Beside the trail, the wagons passed little grave markers, and the company remembered the people who had died.

One Sunday the company stopped beside the Platte River. The leaders, Captain Snow, waded out into the water. Some people were sick and wanted to be well. Others wanted to step into the water and make their promise to God again.

That evening Edward walked down into the river too. He was fifty-two years old. It was the seventh week of the journey, and he wanted to make his promise fresh again.

Mary Ann knew how things ought to be done, and she was not afraid to say so. Some of the men grumbled. But she helped keep the wagons rolling.

One night the dogs barked and barked. Edward looked out and saw a big animal in the dark. He let the dogs run, and the animal went away. No one saw it clearly. Maybe it was a bear.

After one hundred days they came into the valley. In Ogden, Edward made shoes and Mary Ann made soap and cheese. Because Edward and Mary Ann kept their promise, their story came all the way down to you.

About This Story

The Promise in the River · Edward Farley Jr. and Mary Ann Moore

This little book is drawn from the full account of Edward Farley Jr. and Mary Ann Moore in The Covenant Path From Many Lands. Nothing here is invented. What follows tells a grown-up reader which parts are documented, which parts were simplified for a young listener, and what was left out.

This is an Incident Story. It is built around one Sunday evening on the bank of the Platte River in July 1850, and it does not try to tell the whole life.

What the record says

In the book	In the record
A farm on a bend of the Mississippi	Edward Farley Jr. was born 12 November 1797 in Monroe County, Virginia, and married Mary Ann Moore on 20 October 1821 in White County, Illinois. Family tradition and federal land patents place him buying land at the settlement of Commerce around 1829, roughly ten years before the first Latter-day Saint saw the place. By 1841 four federal patents totaling nearly 400 acres in Appanoose Township stood in his name or jointly with associates.
A city built right around the farm	In the spring of 1839 the Saints, expelled from Missouri, purchased the swampy Commerce settlement, renamed it Nauvoo, and built it into a city that rivaled Chicago as the largest in Illinois within two years. The Farley land was not near this. It was in the middle of it.
They watched for eight years	Between 1839 and 1847 the family witnessed the whole arc of Nauvoo. Their son Winthrop was born at Commerce on 15 January 1831, on land his father had already been farming. They were in Hancock County on 27 June 1844 when Joseph and Hyrum Smith were killed at Carthage, a few miles from their farm.
Watching them walk across the ice	In the early weeks of February 1846 the Mississippi froze solid and roughly twelve thousand people abandoned a finished temple and crossed into Iowa. The Farleys did not go with them. They stayed in Hancock County and later moved east to Pilot Grove.
One spring day they were baptized	Edward and Mary Ann, with their son Isaac, were baptized on 7 May 1847 at Pilot Grove, Hancock County, Illinois. Which elder and which waters is not yet known and awaits the Pilot Grove branch records at the FamilySearch Library. By 30 March 1848 they were at the east bank of the Missouri receiving Patriarchal Blessings from Isaac Morley, which could only be given to confirmed members in good standing.

In the book	In the record
Seventeen wagons and three hundred cattle	Edward sold the Commerce and Nauvoo properties in January 1850 and the party set out on 21 May 1850. Their granddaughter Madeleine Harrop recorded that they assembled seventeen wagons of provisions and three hundred head of cattle. They were not poor emigrants.
One hundred and thirty six wagons	The family joined the William Snow and Joseph Young Company at Kanesville, Iowa, on 21 June 1850. The company crossed with 136 wagons and nearly 500 people under the two co-captains.
Little graves beside the trail	Cholera moved through the camps. By Fort Kearney in early July the company had passed 53 graves. Six deaths had occurred within their own camp by the end of June, and by late July Angelina Farley had counted 155 graves along the trail.
Captain Snow in the water	On 7 July 1850 Captain William Snow recorded a Sunday gathering on the bank of the Platte. He baptized several members of the company that day, some for their health and others in renewal of their covenants, and in the evening he wrote that he baptized Brother Farley.
Fifty two years old, the seventh week	Edward was fifty two. The company had left Kanesville on 21 June, so 7 July fell in the seventh week counting from the 21 May departure from Illinois.
Mary Ann had a great deal to say	Near Fort Laramie, Angelina Farley recorded in her trail diary that the train felt Mother had too much say so about every thing. The teamster who tried to confront her got angry but said little because it was to a woman.
The night the dogs barked	In late August 1850, near the last crossing of the Platte, Angelina Farley was woken in the night by the dogs barking furiously. She wrote that Mr. Farley looked out and saw an animal about the size of a yearling calf. He loosed the dogs. The family concluded it may have been a bear. The cattle were safe.
Shoes, soap, candles, and cheese	The family settled at Ogden in Weber County. Edward made shoes for the early pioneer community. Mary Ann turned wool into yarn and bats, made her own dyes, soap, charcoal, tallow candles, butter and cheese, and taught these arts to her neighbors. A granddaughter called her a genius in all kinds of home industry.

The most important thing to explain to a child who asks

The river on page ten is not Edward's first baptism. He was baptized three years earlier in Illinois, which is page five. What happened on the Platte was a rebaptism, a practice common among the pioneers, in which members went back into the water to

renew their covenants. Captain Snow baptized some of the company that day for their health and others in renewal. The book says they wanted to promise again and that Edward wanted to start over, which is what the practice meant, without asking a five year old to hold the word rebaptism.

What was simplified

Three people are named in this book. They are Edward, Mary Ann, and Captain Snow.

Page eight says the children counted the graves. The counting is documented, in Angelina Farley's diary, but she was an adult and it was she who kept the tally.

Page twelve says they thought it must have been a bear. Angelina wrote only that they concluded it may have been one. Nobody ever saw it in daylight and nobody ever knew.

Page eleven compresses a long stretch of trail into one idea. The family also split off from the main company for several weeks with nine wagons after a quarrel among the teamsters, and Captain Snow noted rejoining them near Fort Laramie on 13 August 1850.

Edward and Mary Ann reached the Salt Lake Valley between 1 and 4 October 1850, one hundred days from the Missouri River. Their son Winthrop and his wife came in ahead of them on 22 September.

What was left out

Angelina Calkins Farley wrote the diary that makes this crossing knowable. A schoolteacher from New York, she was thirty three when she married nineteen year old Winthrop Farley at Squire Taylor's house on the evening of 20 May 1850, the night before the trek began. Her nineteen pages of daily entries record the cholera graves, the buffalo, the exhausted cattle, the night the dogs barked, and her arrival in the valley with scarcely life enough to rejoice. She died in Ogden on 21 January 1900.

Edward Farley Jr. died on 24 August 1867 in Ogden at the age of sixty nine. Mary Ann outlived him by seventeen years and died on 15 October 1884 at the age of eighty one. Both are buried at the Ogden City Cemetery.

A caution for anyone who goes looking. The FamilySearch profile for Edward carries a second wife named Polly Boone, added by a GEDCOM import in 2016 with no sources behind it. Polly was simply the family nickname for Mary Ann, and Angelina's diary uses both names for the same woman. Mary Ann Moore was his only wife.

Reunion game facts in this book

Game fact	Where it is
Owned land at Commerce about ten years before it was renamed Nauvoo	Pages one and two

Game fact	Where it is
Watched the whole rise and fall of Nauvoo without joining the Church until afterward	Pages three, four, and five
The family crossed with seventeen wagons and three hundred head of cattle	Page six
Edward was baptized in the Platte River at fifty two, seven weeks into the crossing	Pages nine and ten
The company said Mother had too much say so about everything	Page eleven
Mary Ann made soap, candles, butter, and cheese and taught her neighbors	Page thirteen

Where this book touches the others

The Ogden the Farleys came into on page thirteen was taking shape around Bishop Erastus Bingham of the North Ward, whose story is Twelve Men at the Door. In August 1851, the year after the Farleys arrived, a fort was built on Bingham farmland and named for him. Three years after that the Aldous family reached that same fort from England, and their story is still to come in this set.

FamilySearch identifiers

Person	FamilySearch ID
Edward Farley Jr. (1797 to 1867)	KWVH-XRH
Mary Ann Moore (1803 to 1884)	KWVH-XR4

Prepared for the Bingham Family Reunion, 2026. Companion to The Covenant Path From Many Lands, story four of twelve.

STORY FIVE OF TWELVE

Eight Miles in the Mud

John and Jane Hastings

Long ago, in a little English village called Countesthorpe, flat fields stretched across thick clay soil. In the cottages, stocking frames rattled all day long.

John Hastings made shoes at a bench by the window. His wife Jane sewed stockings for the shops in town. Their cottage was small and full of children.

Two doors away, Jane's mother and her brother joined a new church. People in the village whispered and wondered about it. Jane wanted to know more.

One autumn, missionaries came to the door. Jane listened to them for a long time. John kept his head down over his work and said nothing.

By spring, Jane had made up her mind. She wanted to be baptized. But the water was eight muddy miles away.

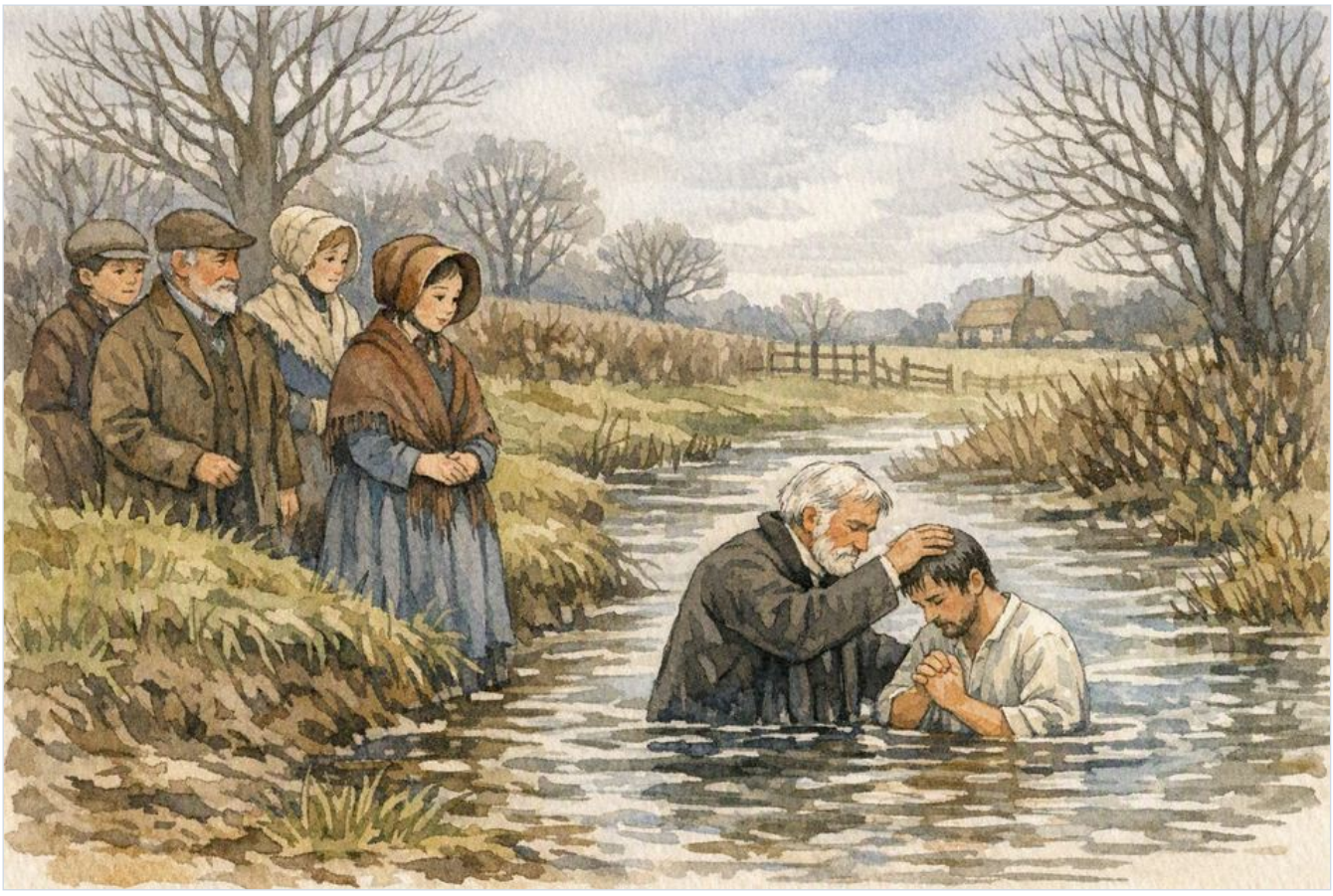
Easter Sunday came, and rain had fallen for days. The lanes were deep in mud. Jane put on her shoes and started walking anyway.

She walked past hedgerows and wet green fields. Clay clung to her shoes and made each step heavy. Nobody from her own house walked with her.

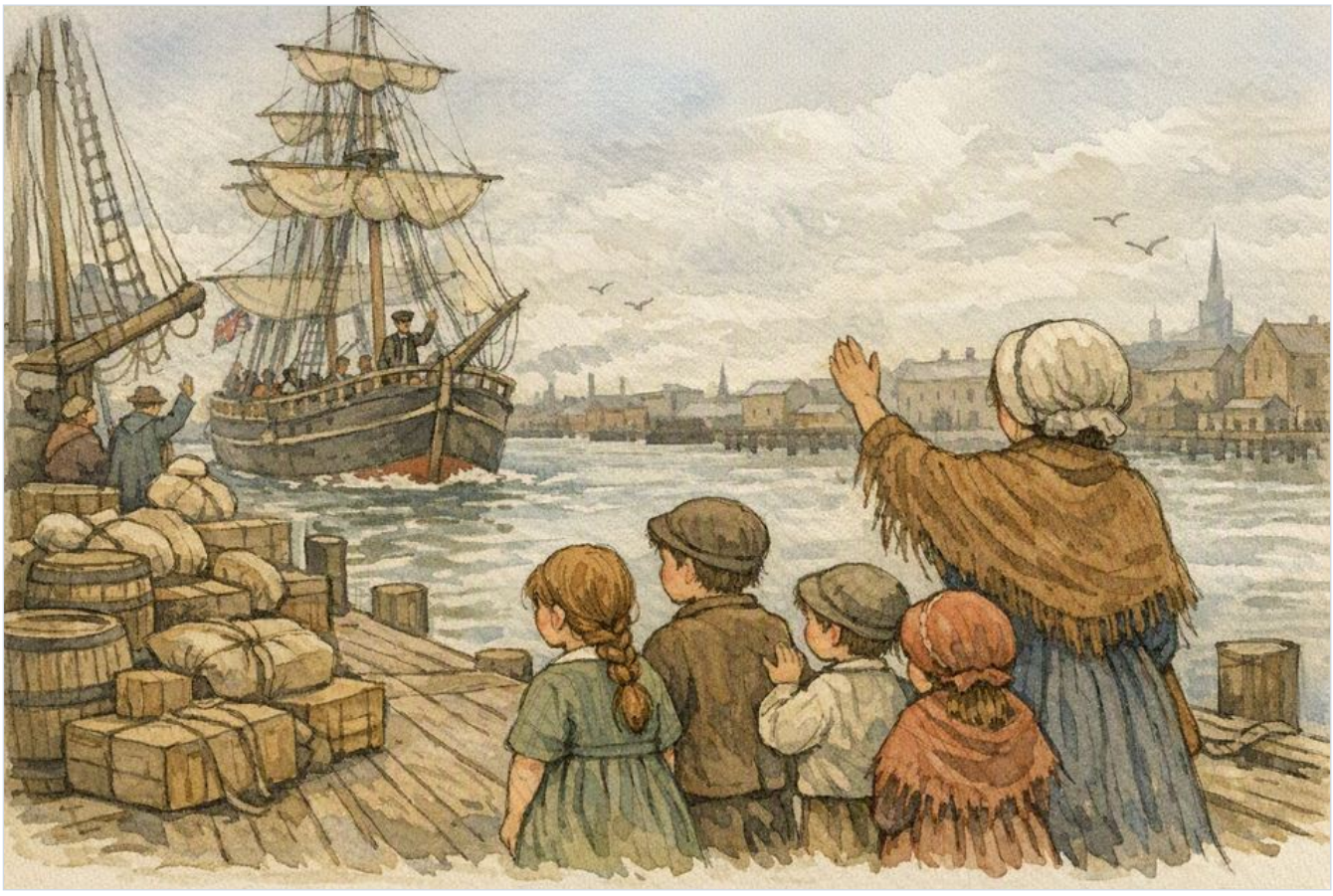
Eight miles is a very long way in the mud. She walked and walked. At last, she got there.

Jane went down into the water and was baptized. She came up wet and muddy and glad. Then she walked the eight miles home again.

John was still at his bench when she got home. He was not angry with her. He simply was not ready yet.



So Jane went to church without him. She kept going for four and a half years. Then, one cold November day, John walked into the water too.



Now they wanted to go to Utah, but they did not have enough money. So John sailed to America alone to work and save. Jane and the children waited seven years.

At last they found John in Missouri. Emma was seven, and she had never seen her father before. They went on to Ogden together. The family Jane walked for is yours.

About This Story

Eight Miles in the Mud · John and Jane Hastings

This little book is drawn from the full account of John and Jane Hastings in The Covenant Path From Many Lands. Nothing here is invented. What follows tells a grown-up reader which parts are documented, which parts were simplified for a young listener, and what was left out.

This is an Incident Story built around one Easter morning in 1849. Everything before page six sets up the walk and everything after it is the long consequence of the walk.

What the record says

In the book	In the record
A little village called Countesthorpe	Countesthorpe sits in flat clay country a few miles south of Leicester. Its economy in the 1840s ran on two trades, framework knitting and shoemaking. The Hastings family lived on Little End Street.
John made shoes and Jane sewed stockings	John Hastings was born in Wistow, Leicestershire, in 1810 and worked as a cordwainer, a maker of fine shoes. He married Jane Burdett on 11 October 1843. The 1851 census lists John at forty as a cordwainer and Jane at thirty two as a seamer in the hosiery trade, stitching finished stockings. Both were piece rate cottage trades worked at home.
Jane's mother and brother joined a new church	Jane's older brother Thomas Burdett was baptized 15 March 1846. Her mother, Elizabeth Shenton, followed on 15 May 1846. Her father, Thomas Burdett, was baptized 14 July 1851, and her brother Richard on 13 November 1853. The faith reached Jane through the household she was born into.
Missionaries came to the door one autumn	Latter-day Saint elders brought the gospel to the Hastings household in the fall of 1848.
Eight miles through the mud at Easter	Jane's obituary, published in Ogden on 9 December 1900, states that she was baptized at Easter in 1849, walking eight miles through the mud. Two independent family histories say the same. Easter Sunday in 1849 fell on 8 April, which is the date the full account carries, though the obituary names only the season.
Nobody from her own house walked with her	John stayed home at his cobbler's bench. He did not join her and did not go.
Four and a half years	John Hastings was baptized on 20 November 1853, confirmed by Elder James Mellor, one week after his brother-in-law Richard Burdett. By then he was the last adult in his household and very nearly the last in his wife's family still outside the Church.

In the book	In the record
John sailed to America alone	John boarded the Clara Wheeler at Liverpool on 27 November 1854 and reached New Orleans on 12 January 1855, carrying his shoemaking tools. The plan was the only one they could afford. He would go first, find work, and send for the family when he could.
Jane and the children waited seven years	Jane and four children were still in Countesthorpe for the April 1861 census. Within days they were packing. They left England on 10 April 1861 aboard the Manchester with 379 Latter-day Saints, a crossing of twenty eight days, and landed in New York on 14 May 1861.
They found John in Missouri	John met them at St. Joseph, Missouri, the outfitting point for the overland crossing. He had been in America six and a half years. Emma had been eight months old when he sailed and was seven years old when she first saw her father.
They went on to Ogden together	The wagons reached Ogden on 14 September 1861. Their first home was an adobe house near 22nd and Wall Avenue with planks for doors and no locks on them. Mary Elizabeth later recorded that the children walked most of the way across the plains and that there was music and dancing in the evening camps.

What was simplified

Three people are named in this book. They are John, Jane, and Emma.

Page eight says it took her a long time. No source records how long the walk took or which water she was baptized in. The eight miles comes from her own obituary and from two family histories, and the branch records that might name the place have not yet been examined.

Page thirteen says they went on to Ogden together and does not name a wagon company. Family tradition places them with the Joseph Horn Company, but that assignment is not confirmed in the primary sources, so the book does not claim it.

The book says Jane went to church without him for four and a half years. The meetings were in cottage front rooms in Blaby, just over a mile away, on a circuit kept alive by a laborer named James Mellor who walked nearly thirty miles every Sunday to reach all of them. He is the elder who eventually baptized John.

What was left out

Jane was John’s second wife. His first, Abigail Gillam, died in August 1839 at twenty nine, five months after their second son was born, leaving John a widower at thirty with an infant and a two year old. Abigail’s parents moved in alongside him. In 1870 John returned to the Endowment House to be sealed to her by proxy, thirty one years after her death.

Three of the children died young. Thomas died in December 1848 at about sixteen months, four months before Jane's Easter walk, and she buried him in the Countesthorpe churchyard as the year closed. Eliza died on 4 January 1859 at the age of seven while John was still in America, so Jane faced that burial without him. Emma, the little girl on page thirteen, died in Ogden in June 1871 at about eighteen. None of this is on a story page.

John Hastings died in Ogden on 5 November 1884 at seventy four. At his funeral, Patriarch Lorin Farr spoke of his faithfulness and his unswerving integrity. Jane outlived him by sixteen years and died on 7 December 1900, one day before her eighty second birthday. She never returned to Leicestershire. Both are buried in the Ogden City Cemetery.

The full account also carries a note on an 1881 Endowment House sealing between John and a twice widowed woman named Mary Goodman, which the evidence indicates was an eternity only sealing rather than a marriage. It is discussed there and is not part of this book.

Reunion game facts in this book

Game fact	Where it is
Jane walked eight miles through the mud to be baptized at Easter	Pages five through nine
She made the walk without her husband	Pages seven and ten

Game fact	Where it is
John did not join the Church for four and a half more years	Page eleven
John crossed the ocean alone and the family was separated for years	Page twelve
A daughter met her father for the first time at seven years old	Page thirteen

Where this book touches the others

The Ogden the family reached on page thirteen in September 1861 was already a decade old as a Latter-day Saint settlement, built around Bishop Erastus Bingham of the North Ward, whose story is Twelve Men at the Door. The Farley family had come into that same valley eleven years earlier, and the Aldous family seven years earlier still.

FamilySearch identifiers

Person	FamilySearch ID
John Hastings (1810 to 1884)	KWJW-YSJ
Jane Burdett Hastings (1818 to 1900)	LKVY-2YC

Prepared for the Bingham Family Reunion, 2026. Companion to The Covenant Path From Many Lands, story five of twelve.

STORY SIX OF TWELVE

The Broken Ship

Robert and Mary Ann Aldous

Long ago in England, Robert Aldous lived in a village called Fenstanton. He was a carpenter. He built wagons, barrels, and barns.

Robert and Mary Ann rented a small timber cottage. Their five children played nearby. Far away, past the trees, stood the village priest’s big house.

There was always work and always bread. But the cottage was not theirs. Almost everything they had belonged to the priest up at the big house.

One winter, a young missionary walked the muddy roads. His name was Elder Flanigan. One night, so many people came to hear him that some had to stand.

Elder Flanigan did not say the road would be easy. He told them about a city that was lost. He told them about a long walk to the mountains.

On a cold December evening everyone had tea together. Then Robert went out into the dark where Elder Flanigan led him down into the freezing water and baptized him.

Mary Ann did not go that night. She had five children, a landlord priest, and a whole village watching. She waited seventeen days. Then she went into the water too.

After that, life changed quickly. In October, Robert packed his tools and the family left the cottage owned by the priest. They boarded a ship called the James Pennell.

The sea was rough. Mary Ann was very sick at first, but she got better. Then, one November morning, a hurricane came.

The wind snapped two masts. It split the third. The sails tore to pieces. Barrels and boats washed off the deck. The ship could not go anywhere at all.

They floated. They waited. They grew very hungry. At last, a little pilot boat found them and towed the broken ship into New Orleans.

They still had no wagon and no oxen. So they stayed in St. Louis. Robert built houses and saved every coin he could.

At last, they had enough money. They crossed the plains with their own wagon. In September, they came down through the canyon and saw the valley.

They were sent north to Bingham’s Fort. Its walls were made of logs. Robert took out his tools and helped build the walls, gates, and cabins.

Angelina had been five years old when they left England. She grew up close to Bingham's fort. Later she married Bishop Bingham's son.

Later Robert and Mary Ann moved up the canyon to Huntsville, and Robert built the very first cabin there. They stayed the rest of their lives, and the family that began in the village priest's rented cottage is yours.

About This Story

The Broken Ship · Robert and Mary Ann Aldous

This little book is drawn from the full account of Robert and Mary Ann Aldous in The Covenant Path From Many Lands. Nothing here is invented. What follows tells a grown up reader which parts are documented, which parts were simplified for a young listener, and what was left out.

This is a Life Story rather than an Incident Story. It runs from a rented cottage in Huntingdonshire in the 1840s to a mountain valley in Utah, and it closes both lives.

What the record says

In the book	In the record
A carpenter in Fenstanton	Robert Frederick Aldous was born 17 July 1811 at Kelsale, Suffolk, some records giving 1812. He was a skilled carpenter in Fenstanton, Huntingdonshire, a village of low clay farmland on the River Great Ouse. He built and repaired the heavy agricultural wagons, brewing barrels, and timber granaries that moved goods to the river wharves. Mary Ann Parkin was born 9 November 1814 at Boston, Lincolnshire.
The cottage belonged to the rector	The family rented a timber framed cottage on the estate of the Reverend Lancelot Robert Brown, grandson of Lancelot Capability Brown, the landscape architect who reshaped the gardens at Hampton Court, Blenheim, and Highclere. The Reverend held the manorial rights at Fenstanton and also served as rector of two other parishes, so he was largely an absentee landlord who ran the estate through agents.
Almost everything belonged to the big house	Landlords of this kind controlled housing and employment together and generally expected outward conformity to the Church of England. The Enclosure Acts had stripped laborers of common land rights, leaving families wholly dependent on estate rentals. Joining a new American faith while living on a rector’s property carried a real risk of eviction.
A young missionary from Ireland	Elder James Henry Flanigan was born in County Down, Ireland, in September 1822, converted as a young man, and reached Liverpool on 5 October 1848. He walked the Bedfordshire Conference on foot through the winter. On 25 October 1849 his diary records preaching at Stanton in the evening to a full house and good attention.

In the book	In the record
He did not tell them it would be easy	Flanigan's journals show his preparatory lessons centered on the History of the Church, including the martyrdom of Joseph Smith, the building and loss of Nauvoo, and the recent trek to the Rocky Mountains. Investigators were taught the price before they were asked to pay it.
After everyone had tea together	On Wednesday evening, 12 December 1849, the Saints and investigators gathered for a tea party and a meeting. Afterward Flanigan baptized Robert in the local waters. His diary for that day reads that he arrived at Fenstanton, attended tea, baptized one, and held a meeting. The branch ledger batch recorded the event on 20 December, but the diary preserves the true night.
She waited seventeen days	Mary Ann was baptized on Saturday, 29 December 1849, seventeen days after her husband. The children at home were George aged thirteen, Georgiana eleven, Charles nine, Frederick seven, and Angelina five.
A ship called the James Pennell	The family sailed from Liverpool on 2 October 1850 among 254 Latter-day Saint emigrants under the direction of Christopher Layton. A month before sailing, on 3 September 1850, their ten year old son Charles was baptized in England.
One November morning a hurricane came	On the morning of 4 November 1850, rounding the Cape of Florida into the Gulf of Mexico with all sails set, a hurricane struck. The main and mizen masts were sheared completely off, the foremast split, every sail torn, and the deck caboose, hogsheads, and ship's boats swept overboard. Mary Ann had been gravely ill earlier in the crossing and recovered near the West Indies.
A pilot boat towed them in	Provisions ran down to near starvation levels before a pilot boat located the crippled vessel and towed it into New Orleans on 22 November 1850.
Almost three years in St. Louis	Without funds for wagons, teams, and provisions, the family stopped in St. Louis from late 1850 until the spring of 1853. Robert worked the construction boom that followed the Great Fire of 1849. The family lived through the cholera outbreaks of 1851 and 1852. Their daughter Angelina Theresa was baptized there on 10 October 1853 when she turned eight.
They crossed the plains with their own wagon	The family traveled with the Claudius V. Spencer Company, roughly 250 people and 40 wagons, crossing the Missouri River on 3 June 1853 and reaching the Salt Lake Valley between 17 and 26 September 1853.

In the book	In the record
A place with walls made of logs	Church authorities directed the family north to Weber County. By 1854 they had settled at Bingham's Fort, in what is now the Lynn and Five Points area of north Ogden. The fort had been built in August 1851 on Bingham farmland and was named in honor of Bishop Erastus Bingham of the North Ward. Robert's carpentry went straight into its walls, timber gates, and interior cabins.
Angelina married the son of the bishop	Angelina Theresa Aldous married Brigham Heber Bingham, son of Bishop Erastus Bingham, on 24 December 1862. Her older sister Georgiana had already been married inside the fort walls, to Martin Henderson Harris, in January 1855.
The very first cabin in Huntsville	Robert hand built a hewn log cabin at what is now 200 South and 7400 East in Huntsville, completed in 1861. The Utah History Encyclopedia records it as the first log cabin built in Huntsville. It survived well over a century and was eventually restored.

What was simplified

Four people are named in this book. They are Robert, Mary Ann, Elder Flanigan, and Angelina. Brigham Heber Bingham appears on page fifteen as the son of the bishop rather than by name, which keeps the count at four and points a young listener back to the first book in this set.

Page sixteen names the cabin and stops. Robert also built the first school in Huntsville and served as its first superintendent, superintended the building of three bridges when Ogden Canyon was first opened, served five years as watermaster, and was ordained a Seventy and a High Priest.

Page thirteen does not name the wagon company or the year. Both are in the table above.

What was left out

Georgiana Maria Aldous, the eleven year old on the night her father was baptized, married Martin Henderson Harris inside the fort walls in January 1855 and died on 30 October 1858, three years later, leaving an infant son. She is the one child of this family whose story ends early, and it is not on a story page.

Elder Flanigan never saw any of it. He died of smallpox in Birmingham on 29 January 1851, fourteen months after he led Robert into the freezing water, at the age of twenty eight. He never returned to Ireland or to America.

Mary Ann Parkin Aldous died on 21 April 1892 in Huntsville and was buried there on 24 April. Robert outlived her by four years and died on 24 August 1896 in Huntsville at the age of eighty five. They are buried together in the Huntsville Cemetery. Page sixteen says only that they stayed the rest of their lives and are a family, which is

where a picture book should stop.

Reunion game facts in this book

Game fact	Where it is
Rented a cottage from the grandson of Lancelot Capability Brown	Page two
Mary Ann was baptized seventeen days after her husband	Pages six and seven
The family sailed on the emigrant ship James Pennell	Page eight
A hurricane in the Gulf of Mexico sheared the masts off the ship	Pages nine and ten
They spent nearly three years working in St. Louis before they could go west	Page twelve
They settled at Bingham’s Fort and Robert helped build it	Page fourteen
Angelina Aldous married Brigham Heber Bingham, son of Erastus	Page fifteen
Robert built the first log cabin in Huntsville	Page sixteen

Where this book touches the others

The fort on page fourteen is the fort from Twelve Men at the Door. Erastus Bingham was the bishop it was named for and the fort stood on his family farmland. Page fifteen closes the circle when Angelina, who was five years old on the icy night in Fenstanton, marries his son on Christmas Eve in 1862. If you read only two books in this set, read these two together.

FamilySearch identifiers

Person	FamilySearch ID
Robert Frederick Aldous (1811 to 1896)	KWVM-KCY
Mary Ann Parkin (1814 to 1892)	KWVM-KCB
James Henry Flanigan (1822 to 1851)	see the full account

Prepared for the Bingham Family Reunion, 2026. Companion to The Covenant Path From Many Lands, story six of twelve.

STORY SEVEN OF TWELVE

The Mother Who Led

George Stratford and Eliza Barwell

Long ago, in an English town called Maldon, the salt air blew in off the river. George Stratford had a shop there. He made chairs and tables and cabinets out of good wood.

George and his wife Eliza had a big family. The shop did well. They went to church every Sunday and tried to live the best way they knew how.

But four of their babies died, one after another over the years. George and Eliza buried them and kept going. They wanted a church that could tell them where their children were.

They tried one church, and then another one. George said the old authority from long ago was missing. Nothing they found was quite right. So they kept looking.

Far away in London, a nineteen year old named Charles Penrose was asked to go and preach. He had no money at all. So he walked.

He walked the rough country roads all the way to Maldon. He walked until his feet bled. The first night he got there, he slept outside on a stack of straw.

In the morning he got up and started knocking on doors. He told people that families could be together forever. He told them that the ones who had died were not lost.

The Stratfords had been waiting their whole lives to hear that. But nobody in the house was quite ready to go first. Nobody except Eliza.

On a day in April, Eliza walked down to the water all by herself. Elder Penrose baptized her. She did not wait for anybody, not even her husband.

After that, one by one, the rest of them followed her. First her son, in May. Then a daughter, later that month. Then George in June. Then another daughter in July.

In July a new baby came, and they named her Emily. She was the first Stratford baby born after the whole family joined. The four little ones were not lost after all.

They stayed in Maldon ten more years, helping the little church there. One of their older daughters later married Elder Penrose. Another married a traveling elder.

Then it was time to gather to Utah. They went a few at a time. One grown daughter crossed the whole ocean by herself to find a place for everybody else.

In April the rest of them boarded a ship called the Underwriter. George and Eliza went, and their two youngest girls. Elder Penrose sailed along with them.

George got very sick on the ocean. They were afraid he would not reach land, but he did. Then, at the edge of the plains, he died.

Eliza did not turn back. She took her girls across the plains with ox teams, and in September they came into the valley. She went first. Everyone else followed, and so did you.

About This Story

The Mother Who Led · George Stratford and Eliza Barwell

This little book is drawn from the full account of George Stratford and Eliza Barwell in The Covenant Path From Many Lands. Nothing here is invented. What follows tells a grown up reader which parts are documented, which parts were simplified for a young listener, and what was left out.

This is a Life Story. It runs from a cabinet shop in Essex to an ox team on the plains, and its hinge is one woman walking to the water ahead of her own husband.

What the record says

In the book	In the record
A shop in Maldon	George Stratford was born 7 November 1807 in Maldon, Essex, and christened at St. Peter's Parish on 21 February 1808. By the late 1830s he had his own carpenter and cabinet making shop at Wantz on the edge of town, listed in Pigot and Company's directory of 1839 as a cabinet maker and confirmed in the 1841 census. He married Eliza Barwell on 17 May 1832 at Great Maplestead. Eliza was born 5 October 1809 at St. Mary's Parish, Maldon.
Four of their babies died	Four of their ten children died between 1836 and 1849. George Samuel died 9 January 1839 and Esther on 19 June 1849, both buried in the Independent Chapel yard at Maldon. Emma died 6 November 1843 and George Robert on 11 December 1846, both buried in the St. John's Wood churchyard in London during the family's years there. The graves are scattered across two counties.
They tried one church and then another	George and Eliza were Wesleyan Methodists who regularly opened their home to traveling preachers. Their son Edwin described his father as a champion of absolute freedom of thought who felt the primitive authority of the ancient Church was missing from the pulpits of Essex. They eventually left the Wesleyans for a small congregation called the Brethren of Freedom of Thought.
A nineteen year old named Charles Penrose	Charles William Penrose was baptized in London in May 1850, ordained an Elder, and received his missionary call on 6 January 1851. He was nineteen. He left London on foot in early March for Maldon, an entirely new missionary field, traveling without purse or scrip.
He walked until his feet bled	He arrived in Maldon completely penniless, having walked until his feet bled, and spent his first night sleeping on a cold straw stack.

In the book	In the record
The ones who had died were not lost	What he carried was a message of a restored gospel, priesthood authority, the eternal sealing of families, and the promise that the dead were not lost. For a couple who had buried four children in two counties, that last point was the whole argument.
Nobody except Eliza	On 17 April 1851, Eliza Barwell Stratford stepped forward alone and was baptized by Elder Penrose, ahead of her husband and all of her children. The full account calls her the mother who moved first, and that is exactly what the branch record shows.
One by one, the rest of them followed	The Maldon Branch Record of Members preserves the sequence. Edwin, aged eighteen, on 9 May 1851. Eliza, aged thirteen, on 28 May 1851. George Stratford on 2 June 1851, baptized by Elder Penrose. Lucetta, aged sixteen, on 1 July 1851. The whole household in ten weeks, starting with the mother.
A new baby named Emily	Emily Stratford was born 28 July 1851 and christened the following day at St. Peter's Parish, weeks after her sister Lucetta's baptism. She was the first Stratford child born into an already converted household.
Ten more years in Maldon	The family did not convert and flee. They became pillars of the new Maldon Branch through the 1850s. Lucetta married Charles Penrose at Maldon on 21 January 1855, with her brother Edwin as witness, recorded as certificate number 35 in the District of Maldon. Penrose then introduced Julia to a traveling elder named William Budge, and after a courtship of two weeks they married on 24 September 1856.
One daughter crossed the ocean by herself	In 1860, at twenty two, their daughter Eliza crossed the Atlantic alone and settled in Davis County, Utah, to prepare a place for the family she knew would follow. Julia and William Budge sailed that same year on the William Tappscott, and Budge was chosen to captain the last ox team company of the season, seventy two wagons into Salt Lake City. Eliza was the first of the daughters to go, and the first of those still living at home, but she was not the first of the children. See the note below.
A ship called the Underwriter	George, Eliza, Ann, and nine year old Emily boarded the Underwriter at Liverpool on 23 April 1861 with 624 Latter-day Saints under the presidency of Milo Andrus. Charles and Lucetta Penrose and their children sailed on the same vessel. The ship reached New York on 21 May 1861.

In the book	In the record
George got very sick on the ocean	Ann Stratford Robinson, eighteen at the time, recorded the crossing in her own words. Her father was taken very sick at sea, the family feared they would have to bury him at sea, and he lived until they reached land and then died.
At the edge of the plains, he died	George Stratford died on 23 June 1861 at Florence, Nebraska, the old Winter Quarters trailhead, without ever seeing the Salt Lake Valley. Ann wrote that they had to bury him in that far off land, and that it was a deep trial to her dear mother.
Eliza did not turn back	The widowed Eliza Barwell Stratford joined the Homer Duncan Company, departed Florence on 25 June 1861 two days after burying her husband, and entered the Salt Lake Valley in September 1861 with her daughters.

What was simplified

Four people are named in this book. They are George, Eliza, Charles Penrose, and Emily. The children in the baptism chain on page ten are named in the table above but not on the page, partly to keep the count down and partly because the mother and her thirteen year old daughter were both named Eliza, which a five year old cannot be expected to hold.

Page thirteen says one grown daughter crossed the ocean by herself. That was Eliza, aged twenty two, in 1860. The page deliberately does not call her the first, because she was not. See the corrections below.

Page sixteen does not say how long the plains crossing took or name the company. It was the Homer Duncan Company and it took most of the summer.

Three corrections worth carrying back to the full account

First. The full account calls their daughter Eliza the first of the family to act as trailblazer, crossing the Atlantic in 1860. Her older brother Edwin and his wife Marianna sailed on the Caravan in February 1856 and landed at New York on 27 March 1856, four years earlier. Eliza was the first of the daughters and the first of those still at home. She was not the first of the children, and the companion book for Edwin and Marianna says so plainly.

Second. The full account states twice that Edwin and Lucetta remained behind in England to complete their service to the British Mission. Lucetta did stay until 1861 and sailed on the Underwriter with her parents and her husband. Edwin did not. He had been in America since 1856, living first in Tarrytown, New York, and then Iowa City, earning the outfit for the overland crossing. He entered the Salt Lake Valley on 13 September 1861, within days of his widowed mother.

Third. The full account states that the Underwriter voyage lasted six weeks. The ship left Liverpool on 23 April 1861 and reached New York on 21 May 1861, which is twenty eight days, or four weeks. This book avoids the number entirely. The account

also describes Charles Penrose as serving seven continuous years in the British Mission, but he was called in January 1851 and emigrated in 1861, which is ten.

What was left out

The reunion in Utah did not go the way anyone hoped. Eliza Stratford Rampton, the daughter who had crossed the ocean alone in 1860 to prepare a place for everyone, married Henry Rampton in the Endowment House on 29 March 1862 and died on 25 April 1863 at twenty five, followed closely by her infant son James. She was the fifth of her mother's children to be buried, and the third buried far from Maldon.

Eliza Barwell Stratford built a pioneer life as a skilled dressmaker, recorded with that occupation in the 1880 census. She moved between her children's households, from Davis County to Providence in Cache County and finally to Ogden. She outlived her husband by more than thirty years and died in Ogden on 8 December 1893, buried at the Ogden City Cemetery. Her life arc is closed here rather than on a story page.

Charles Penrose became editor of the Deseret News, a member of the Quorum of the Twelve Apostles in 1904, president of the British Mission, and First Counselor in the First Presidency under two Church Presidents. He died in Salt Lake City on 16 May 1925 at ninety three. When Julia Stratford Budge died in 1912, he personally spoke at her funeral in the Logan Tabernacle, sixty one years after he walked bleeding into Maldon and baptized her mother.

Reunion game facts in this book

Game fact	Where it is
A nineteen year old missionary walked to Maldon until his feet bled	Pages five and six
He slept his first night on a straw stack	Pages six and seven
Eliza was baptized first, alone, ahead of her husband and children	Pages eight and nine
The whole household followed her into the water within ten weeks	Page ten
George died at Florence, Nebraska, without ever seeing the valley	Page fifteen
The widowed Eliza refused to turn back and crossed the plains anyway	Page sixteen

Where this book touches the others

There is a second Stratford book in this set. Edwin, the eighteen year old son who was the first to follow his mother into the water on page ten, has his own story with his wife Marianna Crabb. He married her on Christmas Day 1855 and they sailed for America two months later, five years ahead of his parents, and the two arrivals converged in the same Utah autumn of 1861. Julia Stratford and her husband William Budge settled in Logan, in the same Cache Valley where the Andersen family of A Promise in the Grove built their sawmill, and Budge shared a ship with the Nielsen family whose story is also in this set.

FamilySearch identifiers

Person	FamilySearch ID
George Stratford (1807 to 1861)	KWJW-2B6
Eliza Barwell (1809 to 1893)	KWJW-2BZ
Ann Stratford Robinson (1843 to 1926)	KWNV-KPR

Prepared for the Bingham Family Reunion, 2026. Companion to The Covenant Path From Many Lands, story seven of twelve.

STORY EIGHT OF TWELVE

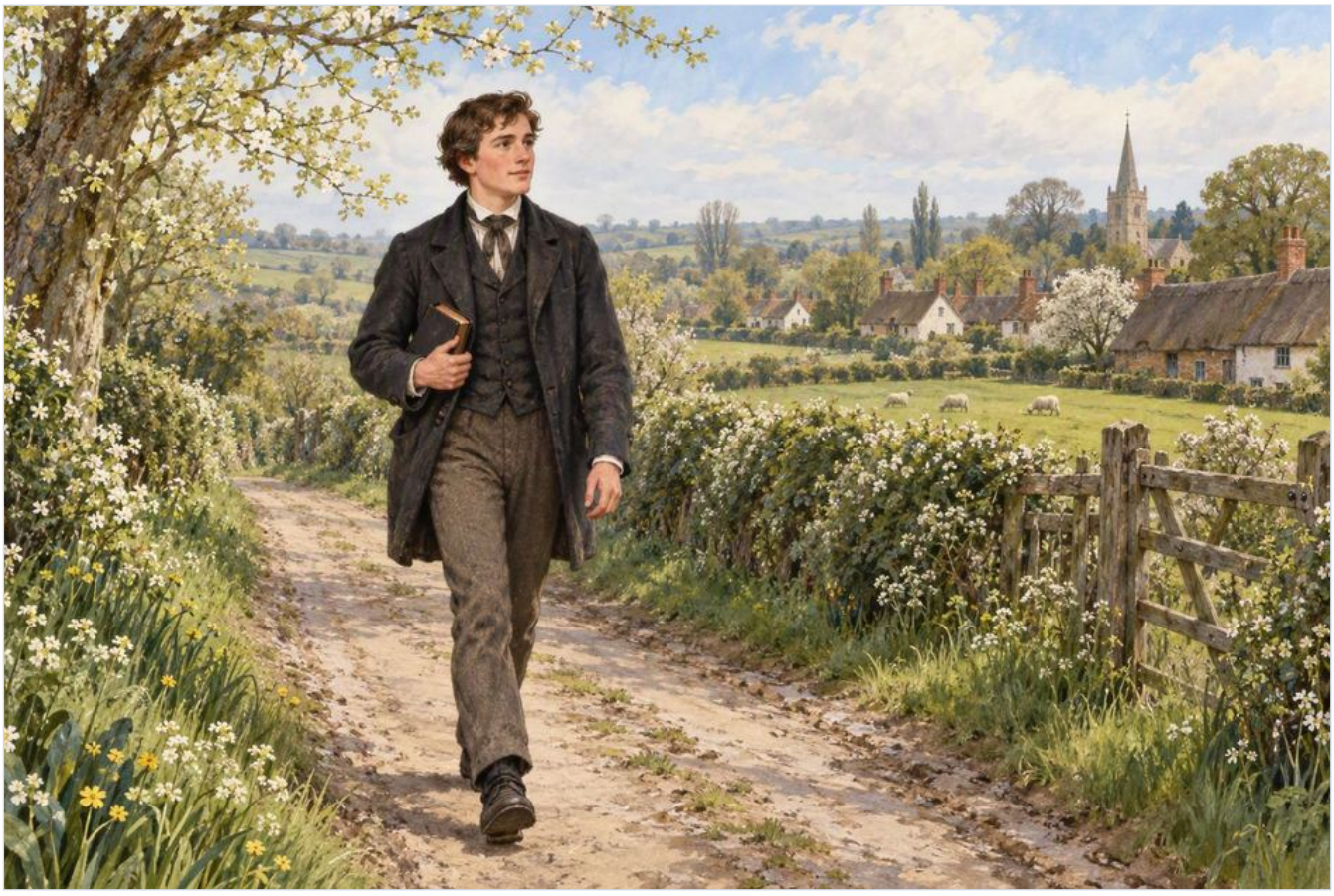
Two Strangers at the River

Marianna Crabb and Edwin Stratford

Long ago, on a high chalk ridge in England, there was a quiet village called Danbury. It had farms and woods and a church with an old stone tower.

A girl named Marianna lived there. By the time she was nineteen, both of her parents had died. She lived in the shoemaker's house and sewed dresses for her keep.

Twelve miles away, down by the river, was a busy market town called Maldon. A boy named Edwin lived there, and his father made cabinets. Marianna had never met him.



That spring a young missionary came walking through Essex. His name was Elder Penrose. In April he baptized Edwin's mother Eliza and the whole town talked about it.

On a Friday afternoon in May, Marianna went all the way to Maldon. She walked down to the water by herself. She did not know that anybody else was coming.

But Edwin came down to that very same water on that very same afternoon. He was eighteen. She was nineteen. They were strangers from two different villages.

Elder Penrose baptized them both. They were the only two people baptized that day. Just the two of them, at the same river, on the same Friday.

Somebody wrote their names in the church's record book. Edwin is on line nine. Marianna is on line twenty five. But they are written on the very same page.

Then Marianna went home to Danbury. Two days later the shoemaker and his sister were baptized too. She had carried her new faith home without even trying.

Four and a half years went by. Marianna and Edwin saw each other at church week after week, in the same little group of Saints.

And then, on Christmas Day, they got married.

Two months later they put everything they owned onto a ship called the Caravan, and they sailed away to America together.

It took five more years of hard work to reach Utah. They had nine children there. It all began with two strangers at one river, and that is where you began too.

About This Story

Two Strangers at the River · Marianna Crabb and Edwin Stratford

This little book is drawn from the full account of Marianna Crabb and Edwin Stratford in The Covenant Path From Many Lands. Nothing here is invented. What follows tells a grown-up reader which parts are documented, which parts were simplified for a young listener, and what was left out.

This is an Incident Story built around a single Friday afternoon, 9 May 1851. Everything before page five sets up the coincidence and everything after it is what the coincidence turned into.

What the record says

In the book	In the record
A quiet village called Danbury	Danbury sits on a chalk ridge in central Essex, a parish of scattered farms and woodland whose working households ran on trades. Its social life turned on the parish church of St. John the Baptist, with its Norman tower.
Both of her parents had died	Marianna Crabb was born in Danbury on 6 December 1831. She lost her mother early, and her father Jesse Crabb died in 1849, leaving her without a family of her own at seventeen.
She lived in the shoemaker's house and sewed dresses	The 1851 England Census records Marianna, aged nineteen, as a live-in dressmaker's apprentice in the household of John Brett, a master shoemaker in Danbury, alongside Brett's family and a fellow apprentice named Samuel Smith.
A boy named Edwin whose father made cabinets	Edwin Stratford was born in Maldon on 6 February 1833, the eldest of the Stratford children. His father George was a master cabinet maker with his own shop at Wantz on the edge of town. Edwin grew up with tools in his hands.
Twelve miles away	Danbury and Maldon are about twelve miles apart. Maldon was a market town at the head of the Blackwater Estuary, with cabinet shops and malting barns near the river wharves, a busier and more commercial world than Danbury's ridge.
In April he baptized Edwin's mother	Charles W. Penrose, nineteen years old and penniless, walked into Maldon in early March 1851. On 17 April 1851 he baptized Eliza Barwell Stratford, Edwin's mother, who stepped forward alone ahead of her husband and children. Her story is the companion book, The Mother Who Went First.

In the book	In the record
The same river on the same Friday	On 9 May 1851, three weeks after his mother, Edwin Stratford was baptized by Elder Penrose at the age of eighteen. On the same Friday afternoon Marianna Crabb, aged nineteen, received the same ordinance from the same elder. They came from different villages and different circumstances and had no prior connection.
Line nine and line twenty five	The original Maldon Branch Record of Members preserves them on the same page. Line 9 is Edwin Stratford, age 18, baptized by C. W. Penrose. Line 25 is Marianna Crabb, age 19, baptized by C. W. Penrose. They were the only two individuals baptized on that date.
Two days later the shoemaker and his sister	Forty-eight hours after Marianna's baptism, on 11 May 1851, her employer John Brett, aged forty five, and his sister Naomi Brett, aged forty-three, were baptized by Elder Penrose and recorded in the same ledger. Samuel Smith, the fellow apprentice, followed months later. When the Danbury Branch was formally organized on 11 October 1852, the entire Brett household transferred together as a single block.
Four and a half years went by	Both remained in the Essex Latter-day Saint community through the early 1850s. In that same stretch Elder Penrose courted Edwin's younger sister Lucetta and married her at Maldon on 21 January 1855. Edwin stood as witness and signed the certificate beside the man who had baptized him four years earlier, now his brother-in-law.
On Christmas Day they got married	Edwin Stratford and Marianna Crabb were married on 25 December 1855 at Chelmsford, Essex, eleven months after Penrose married Lucetta. They had shared a baptismal date, a branch, and four and a half years of faith in the same community.
A ship called the Caravan	Two months after the wedding, in February 1856, they sailed for America aboard the emigrant ship Caravan, putting in to New York harbor on 27 March 1856. They crossed the Atlantic in the first weeks of their married life, five years ahead of Edwin's parents.
Five more years of hard work	Lacking the means for an overland outfit, they settled first in Tarrytown, New York, and then Iowa City, Iowa. Edwin worked as a carpenter and Marianna as a dressmaker, the same trades that had supported each of them before the water, now earning the wagons and provisions the crossing required. Their wagon entered the Salt Lake Valley on 13 September 1861.

In the book	In the record
Nine children	Edwin and Marianna settled first in Farmington, then Providence near Logan in Cache County. Their nine children were Edwin Alfred, Eliza Ann, Jesse George, Charles Henry, Francis William, Lillian Marianna, Albert Edgar, Egbert Chapman, and Horace Barwell. The last name was a quiet tribute to Eliza Barwell, the grandmother who had stepped into the water first.

What was simplified

Three people are named in this book. They are Marianna, Edwin, and Elder Penrose. The shoemaker on pages two and nine is John Brett and his sister is Naomi Brett, both named in the table above.

Page five says Marianna walked all the way to Maldon. The record does not say how she traveled the twelve miles, only that she was baptized there. Walking was the ordinary way for a dressmaker's apprentice to cover that distance, but the sources do not state it.

Page six says they were strangers. The full account says they came from different villages and different circumstances and had no way of knowing what the day would lead to. No source states that they had ever met, only that nothing connected them.

Page thirteen does not name the wagon company. The pioneer company for their 1861 crossing has not yet been confirmed in the Mormon Pioneer Overland Travel Database.

What was left out

The marriage date of 25 December 1855 rests on the Find a Grave memorial for Edwin, which states that he married Marianna Crabb on Christmas Day 1855. It still wants confirmation from the England and Wales civil registration marriage index. For a date this good, it is worth getting right.

Edwin's later life filled out considerably. He managed the Ogden Junction newspaper and then the George A. Lowe Company, founded E. Stratford and Sons furniture in 1882, served as deputy collector and assessor of Cache County, and was Bishop of the Ogden Fourth Ward from 1883 until his death. The carpenter's son who went into the water at eighteen served as a bishop for sixteen years.

Edwin Stratford died in Ogden on 8 October 1899 at the age of sixty-six. Marianna outlived him by nearly twenty years and died in Ogden on 26 September 1919 at eighty-seven. They are buried together in the Ogden City Cemetery. The orphaned apprentice from Danbury had crossed an ocean, raised nine children, and outlived everyone who had known her as an orphan.

Reunion game facts in this book

Game fact	Where it is
Marianna was an orphan working as a dressmaker’s apprentice in a shoemaker’s household	Page two
They were baptized on the same Friday afternoon in May 1851	Pages five through seven
They were the only two people baptized that day	Pages seven and eight
They were strangers from different villages, aged eighteen and nineteen	Pages three and six
Her employer and his sister were baptized forty eight hours later	Page nine
They were not married until Christmas Day 1855, four and a half years later	Pages ten and eleven

Where this book touches the others

The mother baptized in April on page four is the subject of The Mother Who Went First. Edwin was the first of her children to follow her into the water, three weeks later, which is the son on page ten of that book. The two arrivals converged in the same Utah autumn of 1861. Edwin and Marianna entered the valley on 13 September and his widowed mother came in with the Homer Duncan Company that same month, after burying his father at Florence, Nebraska.

FamilySearch identifiers

Person	FamilySearch ID
Marianna Crabb (1831 to 1919)	KWJW-TST
Edwin Stratford (1833 to 1899)	KWJW-2BH
Lucetta Stratford (married Penrose 1855)	KWJW-L8Z

Prepared for the Bingham Family Reunion, 2026. Companion to The Covenant Path From Many Lands, story eight of twelve.

STORY NINE OF TWELVE

The Boy Who Climbed the Rigging

Jens Nielsen and Ane Margrethe Pedersdatter

Long ago, on the windy north coast of Denmark, there was a little fishing village called Liseleje. A boy named Jens was born there in December, close beside the sea.

Jens learned to read the clouds and keep a boat steady on rough water. He also learned to climb the ropes all the way to the top of the mast, and he was not afraid.

A few miles down the same shore, a girl named Ane Margrethe was born that very same year. She grew up in a village called Torup, listening to the same waves.

When Ane was twenty-three, she married a young sailor. Just forty-three days after their wedding, his ship was lost in a battle far away. He never came home.

A few years later, Jens and Ane married each other. Soon they had children. In Denmark, their children were called Jensen, which means “children of Jens.”

Then missionaries came walking along the coast road with a new message. Jens and Ane listened and learned for a long time. One April, they were both baptized.

Now they wanted to travel to Utah with the other Saints. But such a long journey cost a great deal of money. So they saved and saved for five whole years.

At last, one spring, they left the coast behind. They rode a steamer to Copenhagen, crossed the water to England, and took a train to the busy port of Liverpool.

There they boarded a sailing ship called the William Tapscott. More than seven hundred other Saints sailed with them. A young Englishman named William Budge was aboard too.

The ocean crossing took about six weeks. Far out at sea, a baby was born and named after the ship. One day, two big sharks followed behind them from morning until night.

In America, they traveled by boat and train all the way to the Missouri River. There they were given teams of oxen. Almost no one in the company had ever seen an ox before!

William Budge became the captain of their wagon train. Through summer and autumn, they walked west across the wide prairie. Out there, the sky seemed even bigger than the sea.

Along the way, their baby, Mary, became very sick. Ane prayed and prayed that Mary would live until they reached the valley. And Mary did.

In November, the wagons finally rolled into Utah. The leaders asked each family what kind of work they knew how to do. Then they sent Jens and Ane north to Logan.

In Logan, Jens helped build the tabernacle and then the temple. Whenever someone needed to climb a tall flagpole or a high wall, the men knew whom to call. They called Jens!

In Utah, the children were not Jensens anymore. Now they were Nielsens. It was the name their fisherman father had carried across the ocean, and it came all the way down to you.

About This Story

The Boy Who Climbed the Rigging · Jens Nielsen and Ane Margrethe Pedersdatter

This little book is drawn from the full account of Jens Nielsen and Ane Margrethe Pedersdatter in The Covenant Path From Many Lands. Nothing here is invented. What follows tells a grown up reader which parts are documented, which parts were simplified for a young listener, and what was left out.

This is a Life Story. It runs from a fishing shore on the Kattegat to the scaffolding of the Logan Temple, and the thread that ties the two ends together is a boy who was not afraid of high places.

What the record says

In the book	In the record
A fishing village called Liseleje	Jens Nielsen was born 1 December 1825 at Liseleje in Melby parish, Strø, Frederiksborg, Denmark, and christened at Melby on 31 December 1825. Liseleje was a small fishing settlement on the north coast of the island of Zealand, where the land flattens toward the Kattegat, the water separating Denmark from Sweden.
He learned to climb the ropes	He grew up learning to read clouds by their color, to handle a wooden fishing boat in rough chop, and to climb the high rigging of vessels without hesitation. The full account calls it a fearlessness his community would one day put to wholly different use.
A girl named Ane Margrethe	Ane Margrethe Pedersdatter was born 19 June 1825 in the village of Torup, a few miles east along the same coast. Six months and a short walk of shoreline separated the two of them from birth. Both grew up in the same parish world, registered by the Lutheran church at Melby.
She married a young sailor	Ane Margrethe married Niels Didriksen, born 29 November 1822 at Kikhavn in Torup, on 21 February 1849, in the depths of a Danish winter.
Forty three days after the wedding	Fighting in the Three Years War resumed on 25 March 1849, and Niels was already in uniform aboard the frigate Gefion. On the morning of 5 April 1849, forty three days after the wedding, a Danish naval force sailed into Eckernförde Bay and was trapped there by easterly winds. The Gefion was set ablaze until her crew struck the flag. Niels Didriksen is listed in the Danish register of the fallen in the Schleswig Wars. Ane Margrethe was twenty three years old.

In the book	In the record
The children were called Jensen	The children born in Denmark carried the patronymic surname Jensen, children of Jens, as Danish tradition required. By the mid 1850s Jens and Ane had at least two children, Christine and Ellen, and by 1860 four, adding Niels Peter and the infant Mary.
One April they were both baptized	Family notes give 5 April 1855 as the baptism date. The FamilySearch ordinance record gives 15 April 1855. The book says only that it was April, because the ten day gap is unresolved. See the open question below.
They saved for five whole years	Five years passed between the 1855 baptism and the 1860 departure. For most Scandinavian converts the ocean crossing and the overland journey took years of careful saving.
Steamer, water, train, Liverpool	The route was well established. Coastal steamer to Copenhagen, branch meetings at Norrebro on 29 April, steamer across the North Sea to Grimsby on 2 May, lodging in an emigrant house, then rail to Liverpool on 6 May and the Hotel Commercial before boarding. The diary of fellow traveler Niels Christian Christensen records each step.
Seven hundred other Saints	The family went aboard the William Tapscott in the River Mersey on 7 May 1860. The ship carried 731 Saints, 312 of them Scandinavians, under the direction of Asa Calkins. The anchor lifted at one in the afternoon on Friday 11 May, and by a quarter to four the coast of England had disappeared.
A baby named after the ship, and two sharks	On 11 June a baby was born aboard and named William Bell, after the ship and its captain. Two large sharks trailed the vessel for a full day. The crossing lasted roughly six weeks, and the passengers were landed at Castle Garden in New York harbor on 20 June 1860.
Hardly anybody had ever seen an ox	A fellow traveler recalled that the company held Danes, Swedes, Norwegians, Germans and English, and that none of them had ever seen an ox team in their lives. The wagons were Chicago wagons with no brakes, only a chain hanging from the side for the steepest grades.
William Budge became the captain	At Florence, Nebraska, on 1 July 1860, the family joined the William Budge Company. Budge had crossed on the same ship, had given the graveside prayers over the dead on the Atlantic, and now led the company across the plains. He was also the husband of Julia Stratford, whose family appears twice elsewhere in this series.

In the book	In the record
Ane prayed that Mary would live	A family history account states that during the overland journey the infant Mary became seriously ill, and that Ane Margrethe prayed the child might live until the family reached the settlements in Utah. The same account says Mary survived the journey.
The leaders asked every family what work they knew	The company reached Salt Lake City on 23 November 1860. Brigham Young, Heber C. Kimball, and Elder John Van Cott, the interpreter for the Danish speaking emigrants, came personally to receive it. They learned the occupation of each new family and assigned them where their skills were needed. Farmers went to Cache and Sanpete Counties. Jens and Ane were sent to Cache County and settled in Logan.
Jens helped build the tabernacle and the temple	Family accounts credit Jens with work on both the Logan Tabernacle and the Logan Temple, and preserve local memories of his skill climbing flagpoles and other high structures, a skill plausibly rooted in his years on fishing vessels off Liseleje.
They were Nielsens now	The children born in Utah carried the family surname Nielsen, a departure from the Danish patronymic tradition under which their Danish born brothers and sisters had been Jensen. The family was planting roots in a new country and accepting a new name to mark the crossing.

What was simplified

Four people are named in this book. They are Jens, Ane Margrethe, William Budge, and the baby Mary. Brigham Young, Heber C. Kimball, and John Van Cott are the leaders on page fourteen and are named in the table above.

Page four says his ship was lost in a battle far away and he never came home. The battle was Eckernförde, on 5 April 1849, the worst Danish naval defeat of the war, with 231 killed and 936 taken prisoner. A picture book page can hold the fact of it and nothing more.

Page five says a few years later. The exact date of the marriage of Jens and Ane Margrethe has not been identified in the available records.

Page six does not name the missionaries. Nobody knows who they were. See the open question below.

Two open questions behind this book

The baptism date is unresolved. Family notes say 5 April 1855 and the FamilySearch ordinances record says 15 April 1855. The ten day gap most likely reflects the difference between baptism and confirmation, but only the primary record can settle it. The Copenhagen Conference membership books are the place to look, specifically

Film 41938 Item 11 and Film 41947 Items 9 and 10, both of which require an in person visit to a FamilySearch center. The same records would name the officiating elder and settle whether a Melby branch existed on its own or whether traveling elders came out from Frederiksvaerk or Helsingor.

Jens Nielsen's naval service is not confirmed. A family history narrative states that he served in the Danish navy during the 1849 war with Germany, which would mean that both he and Ane Margrethe's first husband were drawn into the same conflict from the same stretch of coast. His vessel and service record have not been identified, and the Danish military archives may hold them. For that reason this book leaves his service off the story pages entirely.

What was left out

Page thirteen ends with Mary surviving the journey, which is what the prayer asked for and what the record says happened. It does not say what came next. The family history account states that Mary died shortly after the family reached Utah. The date and the place of burial have not been documented. A child who asks what happened to the baby can be told the truth, which is that the prayer was answered and that she did not live much longer.

The plains crossing was harder than page twelve admits. Smallpox broke out aboard the William Tapscott in late May, children died at sea and were buried in the water, and an eighty two year old Danish woman was sewn into canvas and committed to the ocean on 27 May. On 26 August, Sioux warriors seized a Danish woman who had fallen behind the wagons driving a lame cow. She fought them off by sheer refusal until a rescue party of five armed men reached her, and she was returned safely to the company.

Ane Margrethe Pedersdatter died on 21 November 1894 in Logan and was buried there on 24 November at the age of sixty nine. The gravestone her family placed over her reads that she was the loving wife of Jens Nielsen, born in Frederiksborg, Denmark. Jens survived her by nearly six years. He died on 5 September 1900 in Logan and was buried there on 7 September at the age of seventy four.

There is one more thing in the full account that belongs to this family and not to a picture book. Jens Nielsen and Christian Hansen Larsen, who is Keith Hendricks' second great grandfather, were third cousins from the same Melby parish. Jens and Ane were baptized in April 1855. Christian and his mother Karen were not baptized until 1 January 1865, ten years later, and Christian recorded that the persecution was so severe by then that his baptism had to be performed after dark. Carol's Nielsen line and Keith's Larsen line were already kin on the Danish coast before their descendants ever met in America.

Reunion game facts in this book

Game fact	Where it is
Born in a Danish fishing village on the Kattegat where men read storms and climbed rigging without fear	Pages one and two
His wife was a widow whose first husband was killed in a naval battle forty three days after their wedding	Page four
The family crossed the Atlantic in 1860 on the same ship as William Budge	Page nine
Budge then captained their overland wagon company all the way to Utah	Page twelve
The children were Jensen in Denmark and became Nielsen in Utah	Pages five and sixteen
Jens was remembered in Logan for climbing flagpoles and high structures	Page fifteen

Where this book touches the others

William Budge on pages nine and twelve married Julia Stratford, one of the daughters in The Mother Who Went First. He had been introduced to her by Charles Penrose, the missionary who baptized her mother, and their courtship lasted two weeks. Logan on page fifteen is also where the Andersen family of A Promise in the Grove built the first sawmill in the canyon, and where a Swiss woman named Anna Barbara Briener arrived two decades later.

FamilySearch identifiers

Person	FamilySearch ID
Jens Nielsen (1825 to 1900)	K241-G4H
Ane Margrethe Pedersdatter (1825 to 1894)	KWJD-S26
Niels Didriksen (1822 to 1849)	K2NL-Z14

Prepared for the Bingham Family Reunion, 2026. Companion to The Covenant Path From Many Lands, story nine of twelve.

STORY TEN OF TWELVE

A Promise in the Grove

Hans Andersen and Maren Jensen

Long ago, Hans and Maren lived on Fyn. Fyn is a green island in Denmark. Their village had windmills and barley fields. Hans owned a farm there.

Maren’s family were millers. For six whole generations they had ground grain on the highest hill on the island. Everybody called them the honest millers.

Their farm had cows and horses and sheep and a flock of noisy geese. Hans and Maren had everything a family on that island needed.

Then some missionaries came to the door. Hans and Maren fed them and gave them a bed and listened to the missionaries. They did that for years. But they did not join the missionaries' church.

One day, a horse kicked Anders in the head. Anders was their oldest boy. He did not wake up. The doctor said he might not live.

Hans was very afraid. He walked into a grove behind the house. There, he knelt and prayed. He promised to join the missionaries' Church if Anders lived.

Anders slept for two days. Then he opened his eyes. Each day, he grew stronger. Only a small scar stayed hidden under his hair.

Hans kept his promise. In March he and Maren walked eight miles to the sea, and Anders came with them. They all went down into the cold salt water and were baptized.

Then they started getting ready to go to Utah. They sold the farm. They even sold the cows and the horses and the sheep and the geese and almost everything else they owned.

Six of their workers wanted to come too, but they had no money. So Hans paid for all of them. Fifteen people left Denmark together.

They crossed the ocean on a big ship with seven hundred other people. Their baby was only five months old. She was sick almost the whole way, and Maren never put her down.

One day they saw eight icebergs floating in the sea, tall and white and cold. Then five whales swam right alongside the ship, blowing water high into the air.

In America they rode on a train. The conductor stopped it at a place called Palmyra and took everyone out to see the hill and the grove where it all began.

They crossed the plains with two wagons and eight oxen, and Hans walked the whole way. He had a good mare named Fan. He lent her to the captain for a long ride in the dark.

They settled in Logan. Hans built the first sawmill in the canyon. Maren saved every egg her hens laid on a Sunday and gave the money to help build the temple.

Hans kept building for the rest of his life, all because of a promise he made in a grove of trees. When he died there were more than three hundred of his family in that valley. You are one.

About This Story

A Promise in the Grove · Hans Andersen and Maren Jensen

This little book is drawn from the full account of Hans Andersen and Maren Jensen in The Covenant Path From Many Lands. Nothing here is invented. What follows tells a grown up reader which parts are documented, which parts were simplified for a young listener, and what was left out.

This is a Life Story. It runs from a Danish island farm in the 1840s to a sawmill in Logan Canyon, and the grove on page six is its hinge.

What the record says

In the book	In the record
A green Danish island called Fyn	Hans Andersen was born 12 December 1819 at Bredstrup in the parish of Nørre Nærå on the island of Fyn, about thirty miles wide and forty long, a landscape of hilltop windmills and fields of rye and barley. He married Maren Jensen on 17 October 1845. Maren was born 2 August 1827, also at Bredstrup.
The honest millers	Maren's family had operated a windmill for six generations, standing on the highest hill on Fyn. They were known across the island as the honest millers, a reputation for fair dealing that traveled farther than their goods did.
Cows and horses and sheep and geese	Hans and Maren rented a farm of some seventy acres with ten or twelve cows, six teams of horses, twenty sheep, and a flock of geese. They were prosperous and well liked and entirely settled in the world they were born into.
Missionaries at the door for years	Missionaries who found a welcome at the Andersen farm in the late 1850s included Jesse M. Smith, Charles C. Rich, Amasa Lyman, William W. Cluff, Patriarch John Smith, and Apostle Erastus Snow. The family fed them, housed them, and listened, without joining. The door was open and it stayed open.
Anders was kicked by a horse	In 1859 the eldest son Anders, later known in Utah as Andrew, was kicked in the head by a horse. The doctor said the child could not live. Andrew himself described it plainly in later years. He lay unconscious for forty eight hours.
A promise in the grove	Hans walked out to a grove of trees near the house, knelt, and promised that if God would spare his son he would join the Church and give everything he had to build it up. The boy recovered. No scar remained visible except one on his head where the hair covered it.

In the book	In the record
Eight miles to the sea	On 13 March 1861 Hans and Maren traveled roughly eight miles northeast from Bredstrup to the coastal village of Hasmark on the northern shore of Fyn, and were baptized in the Kattegat. Their son Anders was baptized the same day. They did not do it in their own village, most likely because parish priests were hostile and a public baptism at home invited trouble.
They sold everything	From the baptism in 1861 to their departure in 1863 the family spent two years winding up an entire life. They gave up their rights to the rented land and sold what they owned. The family history records that they realized roughly fifteen thousand dollars.
Hans paid for all six of them	Hans paid the passage not only for his own family but for six hired workers who had also accepted the faith and could not afford to emigrate. Fifteen people left Denmark together under his sponsorship. Relatives and friends tried to talk them out of going. None of it moved them.
A big ship with seven hundred people	The family left Denmark on 18 April 1863 and boarded the packet ship John J. Boyd at Liverpool on 30 April. She carried 767 Latter-day Saint emigrants, most of them Scandinavian, under the presidency of William W. Cluff. The crossing reached New York on 29 May 1863.
Their baby was five months old	Their seventh child, Ane, was born 3 November 1862 and was five months old when the family left. The family history records that she was very sickly throughout the ocean crossing and the overland journey, and that at times they did not believe she would survive the fourteen hundred miles to Salt Lake City. She did.
Eight icebergs and five whales	On 21 May 1863 the ship passed eight massive icebergs in the Atlantic, and five whales swam alongside the vessel throwing plumes of water into the air. For children raised on a Danish island there was nothing in their experience to prepare them for the scale of it.
The train stopped at Palmyra	The conductor on the westward train claimed acquaintance with the Prophet Joseph Smith. He stopped the train at Palmyra, New York, and showed the passengers the hill, the grove, and the house. The family history says the news ran like wildfire from car to car as passengers pressed to get out and touch the ground.

In the book	In the record
Two wagons and a mare named Fan	The family joined the John R. Young Company at Florence, Nebraska, on 30 June 1863, traveling with two wagons at four yoke of oxen each and one light spring wagon for the women and children. Hans walked beside the wagons. Captain Young's own account names Hans by name and records borrowing his mare Fan for a twenty five mile night ride to recover a stolen ox. The company reached the Salt Lake Valley on 12 September 1863.
The first sawmill in the canyon	Hans went north to Logan rather than south with most of the company. He bought a lot in the Fourth Ward, then farmland north of town, then a place up Logan Canyon where he built the first sawmill in the northern settlements equipped with a circle saw, paying nine hundred dollars for the wheel alone. He later brought in the valley's first threshing machine and built a flour mill.
Eggs laid on a Sunday	When Brigham Young dedicated the Logan temple site in May 1877 and gave the Saints seven years to finish it, Maren paid all of the eggs gathered on Sundays toward the temple fund. By the time the temple was dedicated, finished one day before the seven year deadline, she had contributed forty dollars from those Sunday eggs.

What was simplified

Three people are named in this book, which are Hans, Maren, and Anders, plus a horse named Fan. The baby on page eleven is Ane. The elder who baptized them is Knud H. Bruun, and the captain on page fourteen is John R. Young. Both are named here instead.

Page fourteen says Hans lent Fan to the captain for a long ride in the dark and stops there. The ride was through Sioux territory to recover a stolen ox twenty five miles back. On the return Captain Young came upon four Sioux driving stolen horses, cut the hobbles after dark, and drove the herd into camp at four in the morning with a war cry behind him. Days later a stampede struck the company and two women and a man were killed. None of that is on a story page.

The book spells the name Andersen throughout, which is the Danish parish form. Hans himself used Anderson for his whole Utah life and the full account carries a note on the question.

What was left out

Maren Jensen Andersen died in Logan on 16 November 1879, after thirty four years of marriage. She was fifty two. The family history calls it simply a great sorrow. She is buried in Logan and did not live to see the temple her Sunday eggs helped pay for, which was dedicated five years later. Page fifteen does not say so, and a child who

asks can be told.

Hans married Maria Charlotta Ek in 1881, a Swedish convert who had been baptized in Uppsala against her parents' strong opposition. She helped raise his younger children, had two daughters of her own, and outlived him by nearly four decades, dying in 1938 at ninety two.

Hans served as a High Councilman for years and was ordained a Patriarch specifically so that Scandinavian Saints in Cache Valley could receive blessings before they had English. In August 1882 he was called back to Denmark on a mission, the man who had left with fifteen people returning to preach to the ones he had left behind. He died in Logan on 5 November 1901 and was buried at the Logan City Cemetery on 8 November, having lived to see his posterity number 330.

The full account also carries a note on an 1873 sealing record for a woman named Mary Christensen, which research has since shown to be a clerical mix up. She was the wife of Hans's son James Peter Anderson. It is discussed there and is not part of this book.

Reunion game facts in this book

Game fact	Where it is
A son was kicked in the head by a horse and lay unconscious for forty eight hours	Pages five and seven
Hans promised in a grove of trees that he would join if the boy lived	Page six
He paid the passage for six hired workers, fifteen people in all	Page ten

Game fact	Where it is
The ship passed eight icebergs and five whales swam alongside	Page twelve
The conductor stopped the train at Palmyra to show the passengers the hill and the grove	Page thirteen
Hans built the first sawmill in Logan Canyon	Page fifteen
Maren gave her Sunday eggs to the temple fund	Page fifteen

Where this book touches the others

Logan on page fifteen is the same valley where the Swiss and Danish Saints of the last three books in this set settled. Another Danish family in this collection, Jens Nielsen and Ane Margrethe Pedersdatter, made the same crossing from the same small country, and a Swiss woman named Anna Barbara Briener came to Logan two decades later.

FamilySearch identifiers

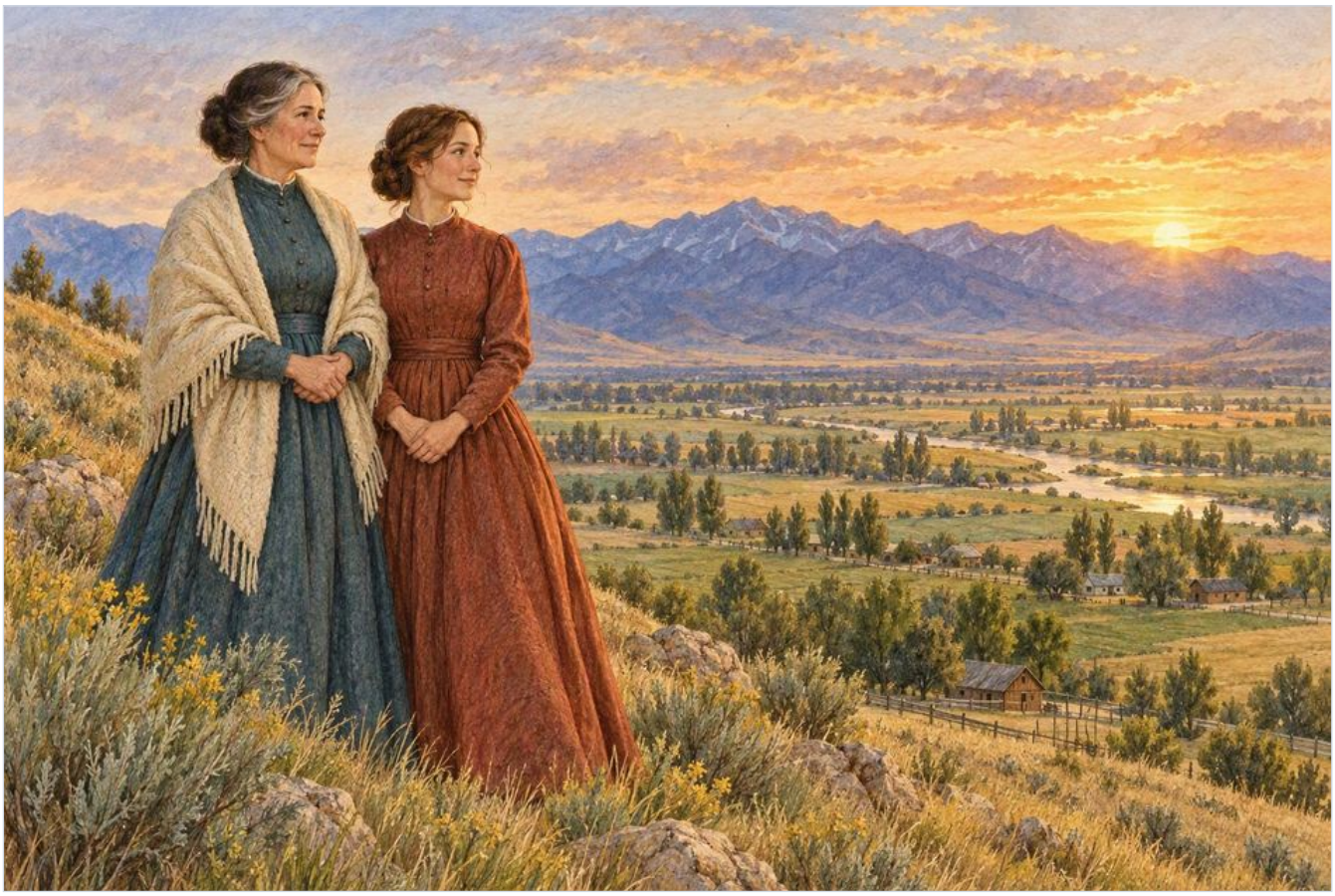
Person	FamilySearch ID
Hans Andersen (1819 to 1901)	KWNX-ZTW
Maren Jensen (1827 to 1879)	KWNL-DLB

Prepared for the Bingham Family Reunion, 2026. Companion to The Covenant Path From Many Lands, story ten of twelve.

STORY ELEVEN OF TWELVE

Two Women, One Name

Anna Barbara Briener and Anna Barbara Keller



Long ago, in the green hills north of Zürich, Switzerland, there were two little farm villages. In one village, a girl named Anna Barbara Briener was born. She was the oldest of nine children.

When she grew up, she married a farmer and they had children of their own. Two of their babies died when they were very small. Anna Barbara never stopped thinking about them.

Anna Barbara also had a little girl. She gave her daughter the very same name, Anna Barbara. To tell them apart, the family called the little one Annebäbbi, a loving Swiss German nickname.

One autumn, missionaries came walking through the farm villages. They said that families could be together forever, even the babies who had died. Anna Barbara listened very carefully.

Anna Barbara thought about what the missionaries had taught her for a long while. Then, one October day, she was baptized in water. At that time, she still lived with her husband and children.

Her husband did not join the Church. He never joined during his life. Anna Barbara believed its promise that families could be together forever, but her husband did not share her faith.

After a few years they were not married anymore. Anna Barbara was on her own now, in a country where almost nobody believed the things that she believed.

She wanted to go to Utah with the other Saints. But a ticket on a ship cost more money than she had. So she waited and saved, and waited and saved. Eleven whole years went by.

At last, when she was forty nine years old, she stood on a dock in England and got onto a steamship. Her grown son stayed behind in Switzerland. Her daughter would come later.

She traveled all the way to Logan, Utah. Swiss and German neighbors spoke her language. There she began a new life. Later, she married a Swiss man named Jakob.

Three years after her mother's journey, Annebäbbi crossed the ocean too. She was now grown up. She made the journey on her own, traveling from Switzerland to Utah to be beside her mother again.

In Logan, Annebäbbi sang in the Swiss German Choir. It met half a block from the church. She was a long way from her village, but everybody there sang in her own language.

In Logan lived Julius, a German miller. His work was to grind grain into flour. He wanted to marry Annebäbbi. She told him she would not marry him until he joined the Church.

So he joined. One February day they were married, and then they went into the Logan Temple and were sealed. Her mother had done the very same thing in the very same building.

Two women with one name traveled from Switzerland to Utah, holding on to their hope that families could be together forever. The mother went first. The daughter followed. And many years later, their family story became part of yours.

About This Story

Two Women, One Name · Anna Barbara Briener and Anna Barbara Keller

This little book is drawn from the full account of Anna Barbara Briener and Anna Barbara Keller in The Covenant Path From Many Lands. Nothing here is invented. What follows tells a grown up reader which parts are documented, which parts were simplified for a young listener, and what was left out.

This is a Life Story. It follows two women across eighty years and one ocean, and the thing it is really about is the eleven years in the middle, when nothing at all appeared to be happening.

What the record says

In the book	In the record
Two little farm villages	Anna Barbara Briener was born 10 April 1835 in Lüfingen, a small Reformed parish in the farm country north of Zürich. Her husband's family drew their legal citizenship, their Heimatort, from Oberembrach a few miles away. She was the eldest of nine children born to Hans Jakob Bryner and Catharina Meyer. The surname drifts across the registers as Briener, Briner and Brinar.
She married a farmer	She married Johann Heinrich Keller on 23 April 1860 at Pfungen, west of Winterthur. He had been born in 1830 near Winterthur. All of their children were baptized in the Embrach church register that served Oberembrach.
Two of their babies died	Their first son Johann Jakob was born in December 1860 and died at fifteen months. Paulina was born in May 1867 and died in infancy the following year. The parish register notes the first boy's death directly on his birth entry. The book does not describe either death, which is deliberate.
They gave her the very same name	Anna Barbara Keller was born 5 November 1865 in Oberembrach and baptized at Embrach on 10 December 1865. In the family she was called Annebäbbi, the Swiss German diminutive, and the name followed her to Utah and onto the lips of the Logan neighbors who knew her.
Families together forever, even the babies	Latter-day Saint missionaries were working through the German speaking cantons in the early 1870s, preaching the restored gospel, priesthood authority, and the eternal sealing of families. The full account notes that this message fell with particular force on a woman who had buried small children. That connection is the reason page four follows page two.
One October day	Anna Barbara Briener was baptized on 7 October 1873, while still living with her husband and children in Zürich canton. The name of the elder who taught and baptized her has not been found.

In the book	In the record
He never did	Johann Heinrich Keller never joined the Church in his lifetime. His baptism came in 2018, performed by proxy by a descendant nearly a century and a half later.
They were not married anymore	Swiss civil registration, including divorce, began on 1 January 1876. The couple were legally divorced sometime between 1876 and 1880. The divorce record itself has not been located, but Johann Heinrich remarried on 6 December 1880 in Aussersihl, and under Swiss law a prior marriage had to be dissolved first. The remarriage is the proof.
Eleven whole years went by	From the baptism on 7 October 1873 to the sailing on 17 May 1884 is eleven years. This is the single fact about this family that appears in four of the five reunion games.
Forty nine years old	She boarded the steamship Arizona at Liverpool on 17 May 1884 and reached New York on 29 May. Born in April 1835, she had turned forty nine the month before.
Her grown son stayed behind	Johann Jakob Keller, born 31 March 1863, never left Switzerland. He moved south into St. Gallen canton and married Maria Cäcilie Breitenmoser at Wattwil on 15 January 1889. His branch of the family stayed Swiss.
She married a Swiss man named Jakob	Jakob Rathgeb was born 15 May 1840 in Dietlikon, Zürich, barely fifteen kilometers from Lüfingen, and was baptized on 1 May 1883. On 4 April 1888 the two signed a Cache County civil marriage certificate and received their temple initiatory, endowment and sealing in the Logan Temple on the same day. She signed the civil certificate in her own hand as Barbara Breiner, her maiden name.
Annebäbbi came across the ocean too	The daughter followed her mother to Logan in 1887, three years after the Arizona sailing, and made her own way into the Swiss and German community there. See the open question below about her age.
The Swiss German Choir	Before her marriage Annebäbbi sang in the Swiss German Choir in Logan, which met half a block west of the Ninth Ward church.
She would not marry him until he joined	Julius Friedrich Hinrich Stender was a German born miller from Curau in Holstein who reached Logan in 1886. The family tradition, preserved in the biographical account compiled by people who knew them, is direct. She would not marry him until he joined the Church. He converted in 1889.

In the book	In the record
Married and then sealed	On 19 February 1890 Julius and Annebäbbi were married civilly in Logan and recorded with Cache County, then went into the Logan Temple where he received his initiatory and endowment and the two were sealed. It was the same single day pattern her mother and Jakob Rathgeb had followed two years earlier in the same building.

What was simplified

Four people are named in this book. They are Anna Barbara, Annebäbbi, Jakob and Julius. Her first husband is her husband on pages two, five and six, and is named in the table above.

Page three says the Swiss way of saying it with love. Annebäbbi is a diminutive, which is what German speakers do to a name for a child or for someone they are fond of. That is as close as a picture book can get to explaining a grammatical form. The Swiss spelling is kept, umlaut and all, the same way this series keeps Wattwil and Fenstanton.

Page ten says she started her whole life over and does not say that she was forty nine, divorced, and arriving in a country whose language she did not speak. Page nine has already given her age and the rest is on this page.

Four open questions behind this book

The first is the most serious. The New York arrival manifest for the Arizona records three people traveling together as one party. A man aged 43 from Switzerland, a woman aged 48 recorded as his wife, and a six year old boy. The woman is written down as Elisabeth, which is not Anna Barbara's name. The age of 48 is one year off from hers, which is ordinary for the period, but the given name is not. Whether a New York port clerk misheard Barbara in a crowded arrival hall, or whether some other woman traveled with Jakob Rathgeb in 1884, cannot be settled from anything available online. The Liverpool departure register, compiled by Swiss German speaking missionaries who knew these Saints by name, is the document that would resolve it. That is FHL Film 25693 and it has not been examined.

The second is the six year old boy. He is written as Gottliek and travels inside the Rathgeb party. No Gottlieb Rathgeb appears in any Swiss church record, any Utah census, or any other document before or after that one manifest line. He never appears in Logan in any form. The likeliest explanation is that he died in childhood before Utah required death certificates in 1905, leaving no paper at all. Whose child he was is unknown.

The third is Annebäbbi's age at her crossing. The full account says she followed her mother in 1887, then nineteen years old. Those two statements cannot both be true. Born 5 November 1865, she was twenty one in 1887 and eighteen in May 1884. One reunion game clue goes further and has the mother crossing with her nineteen year

old daughter, which would put them on the same ship. The Arizona manifest does not support that, because the party is three people and a fourth young woman is not among them. The best reading is that the 1887 crossing is right and the age of nineteen is wrong, but the departure register would settle this too.

The fourth is a child who may not belong to this family at all. A Joseph Keller, born 23 October 1872 and later naturalized in Cleveland, Ohio, appears in some family trees as a fifth child. The Embrach baptism register for 1851 to 1875 has been searched entry by entry, and his siblings Anna Barbara and Paulina were found there, which confirms the search was done correctly. No baptism exists for any Joseph or Josef Keller to this couple. The birthplace given for him in those trees is an unsourced assumption. He is excluded from this book and should stay tagged as a hypothesis until a primary source names his parents.

What was left out

Annebäbbi did not grow old. She fell ill in her early forties, was seriously sick for many months, and was confined to her bed through the last half year of her life. She died on 1 October 1906 at her home in Logan's Sixth Ward, of what the newspaper described as incipient diabetes and nervous prostration. She was forty. Six children had been born to her and four were living. Her daughter Martha, twelve years old, took on the household with the help of neighbors. Her death notice remembered her as a good wife, fond mother and faithful Saint.

Anna Barbara Briener outlived her daughter by eight years. Jakob Rathgeb died on 5 January 1911. She died on 8 September 1914 in Logan at the age of seventy nine, a month after the war broke out in the Europe she had left thirty years before, and was buried two days later in the Logan City Cemetery. She never went back to Switzerland. The daughter who crossed the world to follow her mother went into the ground first. That is the fact this book deliberately ends before.

Reunion game facts in this book

Game fact	Where it is
Born in a small Swiss village near Zürich in 1835, eldest of nine children	Page one
Baptized in October 1873 while still living under her husband's roof	Pages five and six
Her husband never followed her into the water and never joined the Church	Page six
She waited eleven years in Switzerland, through a civil divorce, before emigrating	Pages seven and eight

Game fact	Where it is
She crossed at the age of forty nine and started over in Logan	Pages nine and ten
She married a fellow Swiss convert in Utah	Page ten
The daughter was known to everyone as Annebäbbi	Page three
Annebäbbi sang in the Swiss German Choir, half a block west of the Ninth Ward church	Page twelve
Annebäbbi would not marry the German miller until he joined the Church	Pages thirteen and fourteen

Where this book touches the others

The miller on page thirteen has his own book, which is the last in this set. Logan on page ten is the same valley where the Andersen family of A Promise in the Grove built the first sawmill in the canyon, and where Jens Nielsen of The Boy Who Climbed the Rigging helped raise the temple that Annebäbbi was married in. Three of the twelve families in this series ended up within a few streets of one another in the same small Utah town, having started in Denmark, Switzerland and Germany.

FamilySearch identifiers

Person	FamilySearch ID
Anna Barbara Briener (1835 to 1914)	2X1S-V9W
Anna Barbara Keller, Annebäbbi (1865 to 1906)	L7BH-32R
Johann Heinrich Keller (1830 to 1903)	2XB2-97V
Jakob Rathgeb (1840 to 1911)	KH7M-SW4

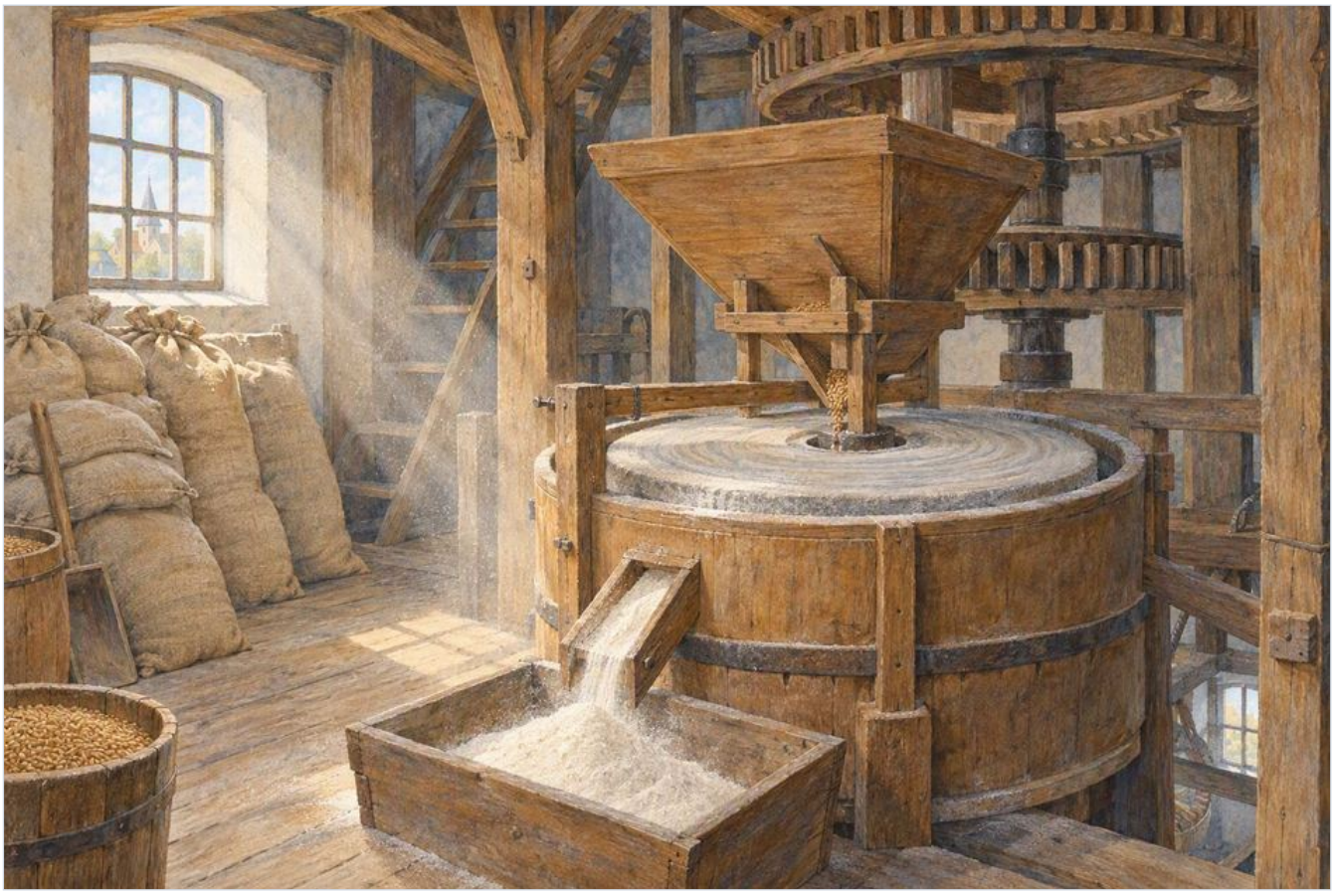
Prepared for the Bingham Family Reunion, 2026. Companion to The Covenant Path From Many Lands, story eleven of twelve.

STORY TWELVE OF TWELVE

The Brother Who Was Waiting

Julius Friedrich Hinrich Stender

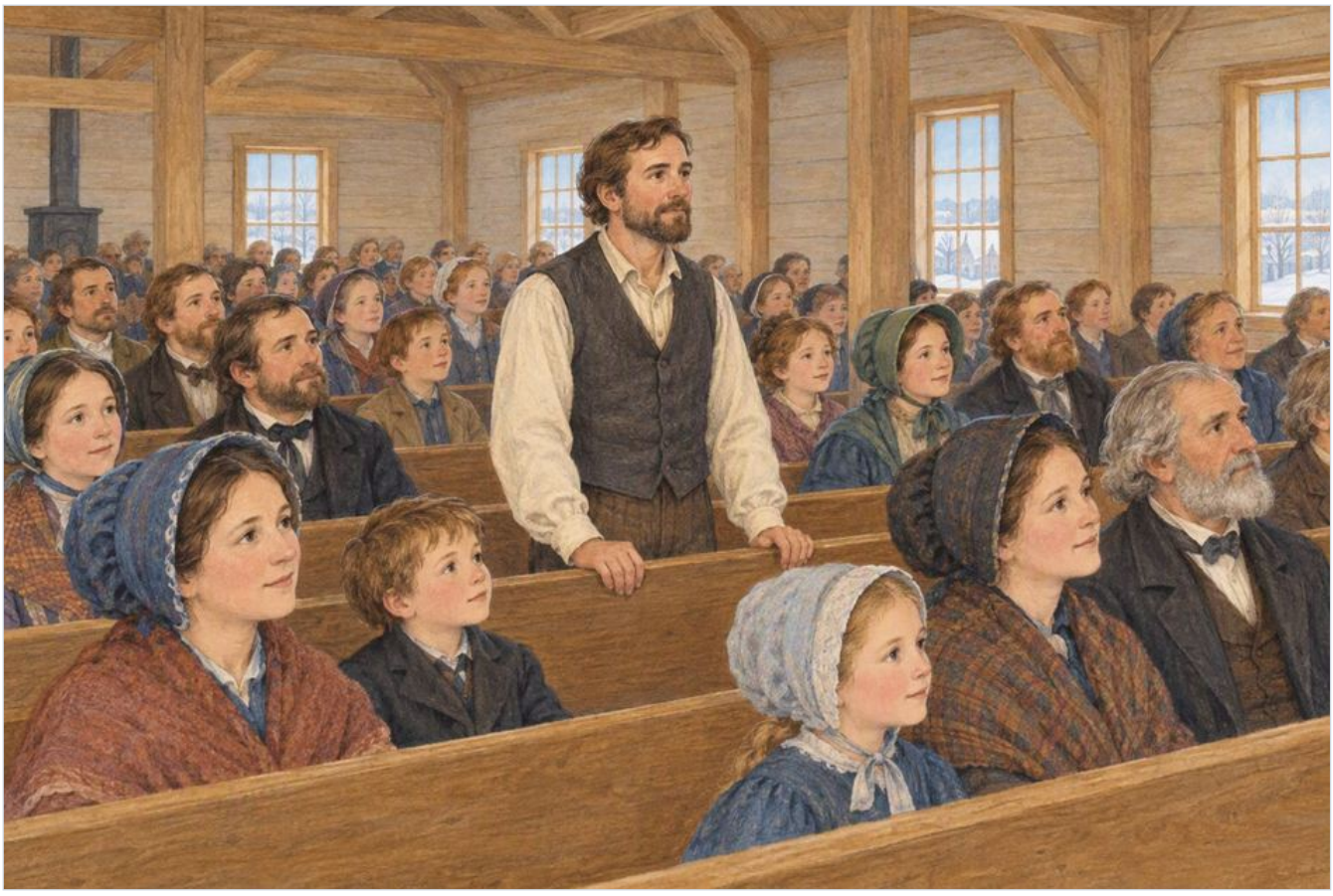
Long ago, in the flat green farmland of northern Germany, there was a village called Curau. The wind there smelled of grain and mill dust. A boy named Julius Stender was born there.



His father was a miller. He ground the farmers' wheat into flour. But he died when Julius was very little. After that, Julius, his brother, and their mother lived together.

Julius started working when he was only seven years old. At fourteen, he began learning to grind wheat into flour, just as his father had done. Milling became his life's work. He worked as a miller for forty-eight years.

Julius had an older half brother he could hardly remember. His name was Henry. He had sailed away to America thirty years before, back when Julius was still a baby.



Henry had gone all the way to Utah and joined a new church there. Once he sat in a big meeting and could not speak one word of English. But he understood every word, as if it were German.

Back in Curau, Julius stayed to help his mother. She needed him. He stayed while he learned to be a miller. He stayed through his twenties and for many years after just to help his mother.

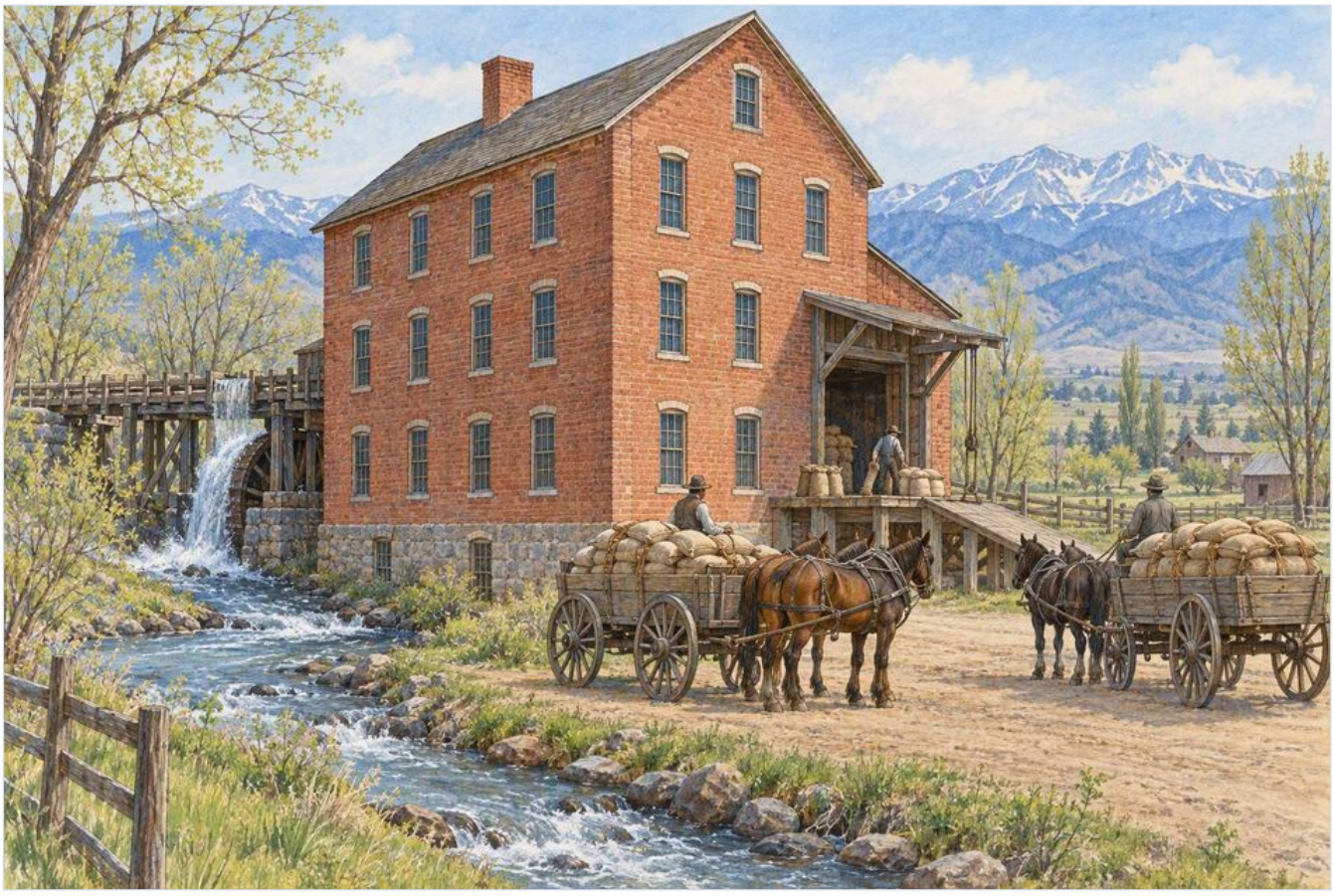
Then his mother died. Within a year, Julius packed his milling tools. He took a piece of paper with an address on it. Then he set off for America.

On Christmas Eve, Julius climbed aboard a steamship in Hamburg. First he sailed to Scotland. Then he crossed the Atlantic Ocean. He arrived in New York in the middle of January.

Then he rode a train for days and days, right across America, to a little town in Utah called Brigham City. He had come to find a brother he had not seen for thirty years.

His brother Henry was there. Thirty years is a very long time, but the two of them knew each other right away. Julius stayed in his brother's house for two whole months.

That year a new baby boy was born in Henry's house. Henry named him Julius, after the brother who had crossed an entire ocean just to come and find him.



After two months Julius went north to a town called Logan, because Logan needed millers. He worked in the big flour mill there. He was so good at it that people began calling it his mill.

In Logan he met a Swiss woman named Annebäbbi. He wanted to marry her. She told him that she would not marry him until he joined the Church. So he thought about it, and he joined.

They were married and then they were sealed in the Logan Temple. The Lutheran miller from Curau had come a very long way from the little village where he started.

Julius ground flour for the rest of his life. The mill where he worked is still grinding flour today. And the family that began when he went looking for his brother is still growing with you.

About This Story

The Brother Who Was Waiting · Julius Friedrich Hinrich Stender

This little book is drawn from the full account of Julius Friedrich Hinrich Stender in The Covenant Path From Many Lands. Nothing here is invented. What follows tells a grown up reader which parts are documented, which parts were simplified for a young listener, and what was left out.

This is an Incident Story. It is built around one reunion in Brigham City in the winter of 1886, and it does not try to tell the whole life. It is also the last book in this set of twelve.

What the record says

In the book	In the record
A village called Curau	Curau sits in the flat farmland south of Lübeck, where the old Duchy of Holstein met the Danish border. It was a Lutheran world ordered by the church register and the miller's wheel, where a man's trade was something he was born into and trained in from boyhood.
His father was the miller	Claus Heinrich Stender was a miller at Curau, not a wealthy man but a skilled one. He married twice. His first wife Catharina Dorothea Loeh bore Joachim Heinrich Christian in December 1827 and died in 1845. His second wife Christina Dorothea Maria Eggert bore two more sons, Julius and the younger Wilhelm.
He died when Julius was very little	The sources disagree on exactly how little. The full account says in one place that his father died the same year Julius was born, and in another that he died while Julius was still a small child. The book says very little, which is true under either reading. The Curau church register will settle it.
He started working at seven	The biographical account Julius gave later in life is precise on this point. When seven years of age he started to earn his own living. He was educated in the public schools of Holstein, but the mill was the real classroom.
At fourteen he went to learn the miller's trade	He was apprenticed to the miller's trade at fourteen and followed it, by his own account, for forty eight years. The German apprenticeship system of the period was formal and demanding, covering the mechanics of the millstones, the grading of wheat, water wheel maintenance and grain accounts.

In the book	In the record
An older half brother called Henry	Joachim Heinrich Christian Stender, known in America as Henry Christian Stander, was born at Curau on 2 December 1827. He emigrated in 1856, wandered through St. Louis and Omaha, and made his way west with a wagon party to Salt Lake City. He changed the surname from Stender to Stander and settled in Brigham City.
He understood every word, as if it were German	Henry attended a Latter-day Saint conference in Salt Lake City unable to understand any English, and yet understood every word President Brigham Young spoke that day so completely that he thought the prophet was speaking German. He was baptized on 8 August 1859 and held that faith for fifty six years.
His mother needed him, so he did not go	The biographical account is unambiguous. In his boyhood and following the death of his father he aided in the support of his widowed mother. He stayed through his apprenticeship and his young adult years, whatever correspondence with Utah may have accumulated in that time.
Then his mother died	Christina Dorothea Maria Eggert died in 1886 at the age of sixty five. Julius had boarded his ship on Christmas Eve of the previous year. Whether she was still living when he sailed, or had died in the weeks immediately before, is a question the Curau death register will answer. What the timeline makes plain is that the two events were separated by weeks, not months.
A steamship at Hamburg on Christmas Eve	The Hamburg passenger lists record Julius Stender departing Hamburg on 24 December 1885 aboard the SS Cumberland under Captain Tait, occupation Müller, residence Curau, destination New York by way of Glasgow. He reached New York in January 1886. See the note below on the second leg.
A train right across America	The transcontinental line had been complete for seventeen years. He went directly to Brigham City, where Henry was then living, and stayed for two months.
Henry was there	By 1886 Henry Stander was a well established figure in Brigham City society, a committed Latter-day Saint of twenty seven years and a property owner with deep roots in Box Elder County. The two brothers had last been in the same place thirty years earlier.

In the book	In the record
Henry named him Julius	Henry's third wife, Anne Christine Neilsen, had children born in the years immediately after Julius arrived, and Henry named two of them William Peter and Julius Martin, after the younger half brothers who had just crossed the ocean to find him. The full account treats that naming as its own kind of evidence. These were not distant relatives paying a polite visit.
Logan needed millers	Central Milling at what is now 122 East Center Street had been founded in 1867 as a water powered farmers' cooperative and was converting to the new roller milling process in the late 1880s. A German trained roller process miller arriving in Logan in 1886 was not an accident. He had the skills the town's largest mill needed at the moment it needed them.
People began calling it his mill	A family memory preserved in FamilySearch refers to the operation as the Julius Stender Flour Mill, which captures how completely he came to define it. He did not found it, and the book does not say he did. See the caution below.
She would not marry him until he joined	The biographical sketch published while Julius was alive states that he became a convert to the Church in 1889. The family tradition is direct about the reason. Annebäbbi would not marry him until he joined. He married her on 19 February 1890.
Married, and then sealed	On 19 February 1890 the civil marriage was performed in Logan according to the rites of the Church and recorded with Cache County, and the couple then went into the Logan Temple, where Julius received his initiatory and endowment and the two were sealed. It was standard practice for Swiss and German converts in Cache Valley who had come without prior temple access.

A caution for anyone repeating this story

Julius Stender did not found Central Milling. The mill was founded in 1867 as a farmers' cooperative, nearly twenty years before he arrived in Logan, and one of the reunion games turns on exactly that point. Page twelve says only that he worked there and that people began calling it his mill, which is what the family memory records. It is described as the oldest continuously operating business in the state of Utah and still produces flour today, which is why page fifteen can say the mill is still grinding.

What was simplified

Three people are named in this book. They are Julius, Henry and Annebäbbi. Brigham Young is the prophet on page five and is named in the table above.

Page two says there was just Julius, his brother, and their mother. The brother living at home was Wilhelm, born 1858. Henry was a half brother from their father's first marriage and was already grown and gone.

Page eleven says a new baby boy. Henry actually named two sons after the two younger brothers, William Peter and Julius Martin, because Wilhelm had crossed the ocean as well. The book follows only Julius, so it carries only the one baby.

Page four says a brother he could hardly remember. Henry left Curau in 1856, and under either of the two competing birth years for Julius, Julius was either an infant or not yet born. The book says hardly remember rather than never knew, because the record will not yet support the stronger statement.

Three open questions, and one new argument

The birth year is the big one. The FamilySearch profile, drawing on the Hamburg passenger lists and earlier indexed records, gives 1857. The biographical sketch published in Utah Since Statehood, based on information Julius himself provided, states 3 December 1863. Six years is enough to change his age at his father's death, his age at apprenticeship, and every calculation after that. The Ostholstein Protestant church books covering Curau are available online at FamilySearch and contain the baptism register that will settle it.

There is an argument for 1857 that does not appear in the full account and is worth recording. The full account states that Christina Eggert bore two sons, Julius Friedrich Hinrich and the younger Wilhelm. Wilhelm Stender's own dates are given as 1858 to 1920. If Julius was the elder of the two and Wilhelm was born in 1858, then Julius cannot have been born in 1863. The 1863 date can only stand if Wilhelm's birth year is also wrong or if the birth order in the account is mistaken. On the evidence now in hand, 1857 is the stronger date, and the Curau register should be read with that expectation rather than as an open coin toss.

The baptism date has not been located. Julius received his initiatory, endowment and sealing at the Logan Temple on 19 February 1890, and those are living ordinances that require a prior valid baptism, so a baptism certainly happened before that date. The Church membership record lists 19 February 1890, but that is the temple date and not the baptism. A proxy baptism recorded at the Mesa Arizona Temple in 1989 is almost certainly an error, since a living endowment cannot follow a baptism performed by proxy decades later. The most likely records are the Logan 1st Ward membership register, FHL number 164,612, and the Logan Temple baptisms of the living for 1884 to 1957. Both need a FamilySearch Library visit.

The arrival has two dates and two ships, which is probably not a conflict at all. The Hamburg list has him leaving on the Cumberland on 24 December 1885 bound for New York by way of Glasgow. A separate FamilySearch entry records him arriving on 15 January 1886 aboard the Ethiopia. The natural reading is two legs of one journey, Hamburg to Glasgow on the Cumberland and Glasgow to New York on the Ethiopia. Note also that an index entry giving Ellis Island as the arrival point is anachronistic

for 1886, since Ellis Island did not open until 1892. The arrival would have been at Castle Garden.

What was left out

Annebäbbi died on 1 October 1906 at her home in Logan, of what the newspaper described as incipient diabetes and nervous prostration. She was forty years old. Six children had been born to them, Julius Henry, Edwin Claus, Martha Barbara, Richard Arthur, Henry and Myrtle Ruth, and four were living when she died. Henry had died in 1901 and Myrtle Ruth was born and died in 1905. Their daughter Martha, twelve years old, took on the household. Her story is in the companion book, Two Women, One Name.

Julius outlived her by twenty three years. He remarried in July 1908, wedding Elise Bärfuss in Logan with the temple sealing on the same day, the third same day civil and eternal ceremony in this family within a single generation. His son Edwin Claus died in 1907. He became a naturalized citizen in 1893, operated the Corinne mill in Box Elder County on his own account between 1897 and 1900, served nine years as head miller at the Thatcher Brothers mill in Logan, and around 1915 established his own business in flour, feed, hay, grain and seed. The biographical account published in his lifetime describes a man who had never at any time received financial assistance.

Henry Stander died on 14 November 1915 in Brigham City, in his late eighties. He had married three times and had nine children across those families, and he held the faith he found at that conference for fifty six years. He is not a principal subject of this series, but without him Julius Stender has no destination. Julius died on 3 January 1929 at his home at 242 South First West in Logan, of bilateral lobar pneumonia, having lived at that address for forty five years. The informant on his death certificate was his daughter Martha, the same Martha who had been twelve when her mother died. His grandson Reed S. Nelson later wrote that Julius had been very good to the Nelson family at a time when they were a poor farm family.

Reunion game facts in this book

Game fact	Where it is
Born in Curau and followed his father’s trade as a miller from the age of fourteen	Pages one, two and three
Boarded a steamship at Hamburg on Christmas Eve 1885 and reached New York in January 1886	Page eight
Crossed as a Lutheran miller, not as a convert	Pages eight and fourteen

Game fact	Where it is
Spent his first two months in America at his half brother’s house in Brigham City	Pages nine and ten
The half brother had been a Latter-day Saint since 1859	Page five
The half brother understood Brigham Young without English and thought he spoke German	Page five
Annebäbbi would not marry him until he joined the Church, and he joined in 1889	Page thirteen
He did not found Central Milling, although he came to define it	Page twelve and the caution above

Where this book touches the others

Annebäbbi on page thirteen is the daughter in Two Women, One Name, the book just before this one. Her mother crossed from Switzerland at forty nine and she followed three years later. The Trenton-Clarkston Mill and Elevator Company, in which Julius held forty shares when it was incorporated in 1906, counted members of the Bingham family among its shareholders, which ties the last book in this set back to the first, Twelve Men at the Door. Logan is also the valley of A Promise in the Grove and The Boy Who Climbed the Rigging.

FamilySearch identifiers

Person	FamilySearch ID
Julius Friedrich Hinrich Stender (1857 to 1929)	KWJ6-SG5
Anna Barbara Keller, Annebäbbi (1865 to 1906)	L7BH-32R
Wilhelm Stender (1858 to 1920)	GQJ5-NQ7
Elise Bärfuss (1873 to 1959)	KWV7-T6Z

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